



Livingstone Oluwalola

DEMYSTIFYING *Dreams*

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERY OF DREAM INTERPRETATION

DEMYSTIFYING DREAMS

(Unlocking the mystery of dream interpretation).

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Demystifying Dreams

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DEDICATION

With prayers, I dedicate this book to seers, dreamers and lovers of God whose souls are on the quest to maximize all that God wants to give them in their sleeping moments. May you become like Joseph and Daniel in the hand of the Lord, whose gift of dreams and interpretation changed the course of nations. Amen.

INTRODUCTION

The God we serve loves to speak to His children. One major thing that distinguishes the Almighty God from the idols worshipped in the nations is that our God can talk. He is neither dumb nor deaf that He cannot hear nor speak. We have access to God through faith in the finished works of Jesus, and by this access we have the privilege of hearing His voice. Jesus said in John 10:27, that His sheep will hear His voice because He knows them and they will follow Him.

Communication is highly important for the success of any relationship, our relationship with God inclusive. For those who believe in God through Jesus, God has sent the Spirit of His Son into their hearts to help them see, hear, perceive, know and fellowship with Him. We are people of the Spirit because we are born of the Spirit and we are led of the Spirit. The Spirit leads by communicating to us in diverse ways, one of which is through dreams.

Dream is one of the ways God talks to men right from the days written about in the Scripture. I like to say that dream is one channel through which God speaks to us without seeking our permission or active participation; all we need do is sleep. Sleeping is natural to men, so also is dreaming, however, a dream that communicates the voice of God is spiritual. God is Spirit and whatever God is involved in is spiritual and will have spiritual origin and inclination.

Almost all men dream, some dreams are purely natural, those that originate from man's mental process when he is asleep. And some are spiritual, because they are inspired by the operations of spirits. We have the God inspired dreams that bring messages from God that need to be understood and received as the Word of the Lord or impartations of godly

virtues for our advancement in the Kingdom. The devil our adversary who seeks every means to oppress, torment and put men in bondage also use the dream gate to speak to and sow seeds of evil into men's hearts, lives and bodies.

In this book, you will come into a comprehensive understanding of origin of dreams and how to discern them, dream reception and how to remember your dreams, dream interpretation, accurate response to dreams and dream application. I therefore, welcome you to a deeper level of demystifying dreams through Scriptural understanding.

My prayer is that as you read this book, you will understand what the Lord wants you to know and you will see more than what is written by the Spirit in Jesus name.

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CHAPTER 1

ORIGIN OF DREAMS

John Paul Jackson, a man blessed of the Lord with prophetic insight into dreams and interpretation once said, *“Averagely, men have about four dreams every night.”* He also noted that, *“By the time a man is 70 years old, he would have spent 6 years of his lifetime in dream-world.”*

Dreams are common to humans, almost everybody dreams. Even those who say, “I don't dream,” will admit that, it happens once in a while.

Dreams are audio-visual in nature; when someone is dreaming, it is like they are watching a video clip on the inside, somewhere in the mind. Dreams and visions are very similar, the only difference between them is that you have the former when you are asleep and the latter when you are awake. All over the scriptures, dreams are often called night visions.

Dream is a channel for receiving spiritual communications. A channel through which the spirit realm and things from that realm access the earth realm through the gate of the heart and mind of a man. God uses the channel of dream to speak to His people to reveal His counsel and purpose.

Job 33:14-18 ERV

“But maybe God does explain what he does but speaks in ways that people don't understand. He may speak in a dream, or in a vision at night, when people are in a deep sleep lying in their beds. He may whisper something in their ear, and they are frightened when they hear his warnings. God warns

people to stop them from doing wrong and to keep them from becoming proud. He does this to save them from death. He wants to keep them from being destroyed.”

Dreams can come from many sources. The understanding of the source of a dream is essential for the interpretation of the dream. If we can tell the inspiration behind a dream, then we are close to the reason why we had the dream. Understanding of dream realm in the light of Scripture is a major requirement for accurate dream interpretation, it will also help us to correct tell the origin of dreams. Let us briefly consider some sources or origins of dreams.

SOURCES OF DREAMS

There are two major classification of sources of dreams, they are; natural and spiritual. Dreams can either be naturally or spiritually inspired. Dreams that are connected to the activity of spirits, whether human spirit, demonic spirit or spirits from the realm of light are spiritually inspired dreams. Dreams that are purely products of man's mental process and soulish activities are natural dreams. Let us briefly look into the various sources of dream for better understanding.

1. The realm of light:

Jesus is light, His word is light, in Him is light and He came to the earth from God who dwells in light unapproachable. The realm of light describes the presence of God, the place of God's throne and the headquarters of His government. God is light and in Him there is no darkness at all.

1 John 1:5

“This then is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light, and in him is no darkness at all.”

Dreams from the realm of light are dreams inspired by God who is light, to convey a message or reveal a thing to the dreamer. Dreams given by God are spiritual revelations or supernatural experiences to the dreamer. He wakes up thinking, “I had a divine encounter or visitation or I received a revelation in my dream”. Dreams from the realm of light can also be called prophetic dreams. Prophetic dreams are dreams where the Lord shows you a revelation or gives you a blessing. This kind of dream comes with a sense of the Lord's presence and His peace, it carries an atmosphere of God with it. It comes with some form of authority, clarity, purity, and it is usually distinct. Here is what the scripture says;

Psalms 127:2 AMP

“It is vain for you to rise early, to retire late, to eat the bread of anxious labours— For He gives [blessings] to His beloved even in his sleep.”

God gives blessings to His beloved in his sleep. This tells us that your dream is a place for receiving God's blessings. The experiences you have in God-given dreams are not a figment of your imaginations, they are real. We read of Solomon in the Scripture, how it was in a dream that God gave him wisdom and he woke up a wise man.

1 Kings 3:5-13

“In Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, ask what I shall give thee. Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people? And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. And God said unto him, Because, thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life; neither hast asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies; but hast asked for thyself understanding to discern judgment. Behold, I have done according to thy words: lo, I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee. And I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the kings like unto thee all thy days.”

In the book of Matthew, Joseph had a God inspired dream where he saw an angel instructing him to receive his betrothed wife and her pregnancy.

Matthew 1:20

“But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take

unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.”

In Matthew 2, he also had a dream where an angel came to tell him to flee with Jesus and Mary out of Jerusalem to go to Egypt until the angel tells him to come back. When it was time for his return, the angel appeared to him in the same manner telling him to return.

God-given dreams can come with clear instructions like that; such that, we wake up with the voice of the Lord in our hearts knowing what to do. Sometimes, we wake up with a sense of urgency mixed with the fear of God that makes us tremble at His word. To not hearken to the voice of God that came to us through clear instructive dream is disobedience unto God.

2. Man’s memory or issues of the heart:

Dreams from this source are usually natural dreams, however, when a mind becomes spiritual through renewal, the dreams from this source also become spiritual.

Ecclesiastes 5:3 GNT

“The more you worry, the more likely you are to have bad dreams...”

Isaiah 29:8

“It shall even be as when an hungry man dreameth, and, behold, he eateth; but he awaketh, and his soul is empty: or as when a thirsty man dreameth, and, behold, he drinketh; but he awaketh, and, behold, he is faint, and his soul hath appetite.....”

Dreams from this source are dreams of natural origin. Your mind and memory are a major determining factor for this kind of dreams.

Your dreams are framed with your imagination, and your subconscious mind plays a major role in making this happen. You actively engage in thoughts with your conscious mind and some of the elements of this thought process slip into your subconscious mind. When you are asleep, your subconscious mind is most active, it works with your imagination, painting possibilities in audio-visual form with the objects of your previous thought processes as raw material. Hence, your thought in the day can influence your dream at night. One of the channels of creativity is to think about finding solutions to a problem before sleeping, do that frequently enough and you are giving your subconscious mind, objects to frame possibilities with. One of such possibilities can amount to a tenable solution to a global problem.

If the daily thoughts of your heart honour God, then you are positioning yourself for heaven-inspired dreams. Joseph had one of such dreams because he thought about a just and righteous solution to the challenge he had at hand.

Matthew 1:20

“But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream...”

Many times, when we have dreams, the dreams are a result of the issues of our heart and outflow of data from our memory database. It's simple, if you think about a lady you like before sleeping, you may have a dream about you two going to see a movie in the cinema. Or if you are preparing for an

exam, reading all through the night; you may have a dream of writing an exam.

Usually, dreams from this source does not come with authority or a sense of seriousness that's strong enough to call your attention to it – this is called vain dreams. However, if the thoughts of your heart honour God, it can fetch you a heaven-inspired dream that communicates a message to you. Also, brainstorming for solutions can give you a creative idea for the work of your hands. This is a major way that people with fruitful minds receive creative dreams, their subconscious mind paints possibilities for them while they sleep; and this has no respect for religion or faith. It is a normal human body-mind process.

Let us consider some examples. Elias Howe the inventor of sowing machine, had a dream where he was chased by cannibals who wanted to cook him. They all had holes in their spears. When he woke up, he got the perfect idea that he needed for the needle-hole he was working on, to finish up the sowing machine he was inventing. August Kekule, after working on the structure of benzene for long without success, had a dream. He saw snakes biting their own tails and that became the inspiration of the idea he needed for the structure of benzene. James Cameron of the block buster movie titled Terminator, fell very sick. He had a dream, there was an explosion and a robot came out with kitchen knives pursuing a girl. He woke up and quickly wrote it down as story line that became the Terminator movie. These are not vain dreams; they are creative dreams that came as a result of active operations of creative minds and productive mental processes. But if a man always keeps vain thoughts, he will always have vain

dreams. Simply put, your thinking in the day influences your dreaming at night.

The state of the mind determines the kind of dreams that comes from this source, the carnally minded will usually have vain dreams, the spiritually minded will usually have spiritual dreams and the fruitfully minded will usually have creative dreams.

Romans 8:6

“For to be carnally minded is death; but to be spiritually minded is life and peace.”

3. Your spirit man:

Dreams from this source are also spiritual dreams. Your spirit is different and distinct from the Holy Spirit. Even though they are in oneness.

1 Corinthians 2:11

“For what man knoweth the things of a man, save the spirit of man which is in him? even so the things of God knoweth no man, but the Spirit of God.”

No one knows you like your spirit man. You can hide your fears from men, you can hide your insecurity and pain from people; but your spirit man via dreams can project them to you so you can deal with them, so you can get deliverance, healing, and be made whole.

1 John 3:20-21

“For if our heart (spirit) condemn us, God is greater than our heart (spirit), and knoweth all

things. Beloved, if our heart (spirit) condemn us not, then have we confidence toward God.” (Emphasis is mine).

You can have a dream where you see dogs running after you because you ran first when you saw them. This could be your spirit's way of saying, “Deal with fear.” God has not given you the spirit of fear, (2 Timothy 1:7).

This kind of dreams carry a sense of seriousness with them. You can wake up thinking, what's this dream saying? what does it mean? Know that your spirit doesn't show only bad things in your dreams. Your spirit man can help you see God's plan for your life.

Proverbs 20:27

“The spirit of man is the candle of the LORD, searching all the inward parts of the belly.”

Your spirit man is God's candle. He can enlighten your heart through dreams. You know that point when you are troubled about a matter, you pray in tongues and sleep off, only for you to have a dream that gave you the answer. If you can get your spirit man active, alive, and strong by much studying of the word and praying in the spirit, you will have more spiritual and prophetic dreams. A strong human spirit will always project what is in alignment with the Word and will of God, and will not project what is contrary to the witness of the Holy Spirit.

4. Soul Contact:

Soul contact dream can be natural or spiritual in nature, depending on what inspired the dream.

A soul contact dream that is spiritual in nature occurs when you make contact with the imprint of someone else's soul and your soul picks up elements and experiences from the person's life and project it to you as a dream, sometimes, using your image as the subject.

Peter Tan once travelled to a place to minister, a country away from home. He was having a great time during the meeting. However, at night, he had this dream of himself being a failure, that kept recurring. He thought within himself, "This is not me, I am not a failure". Peter, being a man of spiritual understanding, made little enquires and got to know that the last person who lived in that house had a whole lot of issues. He was almost not successful at anything he attempted to do. He was living as a failure. So here was Peter dreaming of the man's experience as his own.

A family moved to a house, and one of the children got a room to herself. She consistently had dreams where someone was after her life to kill her. She wakes up most nights scared, without any willingness to return to sleep. They were a Christian family, so they got praying, but the nightmares wouldn't stop. Fortunately, they made some research and got to know that there was once a murder case that happened in that room; someone had killed another person before they moved in. They got the spiritual intelligence to pray right. They sanctified the whole house and anointed it unto the Lord and the nightmares ceased.

Those who have this kind of dream the most, are people with very sensitive spirits. How do you relate to such dreams? Prayerfully break free from the atmospheric influence of your soul. By your words, proclaim your freedom. Purify the atmosphere by utterances of life, speak the word as it relates to the situation.

Sometimes, God wants you to intercede for the person and may give you a solution for the person's ill, which He may have you communicate to them – in a case where you know the person personally.

This is the same principle at work when a minister picks up someone's pain in the congregation as word of knowledge, by he/she having pain at that particular part of their body. I was ministering somewhere one day, when I felt a sharp pain on my right knee. I knew I didn't go there with such pain, so I asked if anyone was experiencing pain in their right knee. Someone signified, he was prayed for and got healed.

You can also have a soul contact dream when you sleep on somebody's bed. You can pick up the details of their life in your dream. It may be your image in the dream, as though it's describing you.

There is a logical side to dreams. When you wake up, ask yourself, 'Does this dream describe my life?' Imagine you had a dream where you engaged in business and you recorded loss in millions. But then, you know you aren't into business and aren't planning to go into it either. You could probably tell that the dream wasn't about you. Praying about it can help you discern who the dream is about.

The natural side to soul contact dreams is when you have a dream that is inspired by emotional attachment to a thing, a place, an event or occurrence etc. An example is someone who was once sexually abused and as a result began having dreams of sexual abuse. The person's emotion is fractured and has an unhealthy attachment to that past event through pain, hurt, offense or unforgiveness.

Another example I will like to share is a personal story. I once dated a lady for a while, but the relationship didn't proper as it should. I was really disturbed and unhappy, but I really loved her. I went to pray and I had a release in my spirit to let the relationship go. I did let it go and trusted the Lord for something better.

After a while, I got engaged to Ayoola who is now my wife. I began having dreams of I and the former lady, I was seeing images of I and her as though we were still together in a relationship. I had this dream recurrently. I knew this dream was not from God and it was not from the devil either. I also knew I shouldn't be having these dreams because it kept the memory of the lady in my consciousness, seeing her every other night in my sleeping moment, which is not good for my heart and relationship.

I sought the Lord and the Lord told me to break soul ties that I had with her through prayers. Soul tie is a strong emotional attachment to someone or something. I prayed and made declaration, cleansing my soul and mind by the blood of Jesus and breaking soul ties and emotional cords. God showed me mercy and I stopped having the dreams.

5. The realm of darkness:

Zechariah 10:2

“For the idols have spoken vanity, and the diviners have seen a lie, and have told false dreams; they comfort in vain.”

When a dream comes to inspire ungodly fear, doubt, hopelessness, pain, defeat, death and all manner of things that are not God's promises for you, it's a dark dream.

Jeremiah 23:32

“Behold, I am against them that prophesy false dreams, saith the LORD, and do tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies, and by their lightness; yet I sent them not, nor commanded them: therefore, they shall not profit this people at all, saith the LORD.”

Dark and false dreams come when the devil manipulates our dream realm. As children of God, we are not supposed to have these kinds of dreams; however, the main thing is how we relate to them and resist the devil over our dream realm. Your response to a false dream is to break the influence of the devil over your dream realm through prayers and to nullify the works of darkness projected to you through the dream. Also, by your words and decrees, consecrate your dream realm to God and his purpose only, as a place of encounters and revelation.

N.B - That you don't like a dream doesn't mean you should discard it as false. What's a false dream? It's a dream that doesn't align with the truth of God's word, just like a false prophecy given by false prophets who speak by false spirits. Dreams that come to warn you of your sinful tendencies are not false dreams, your response to that is to repent and turn from sinful ways and receive grace from God to live upright. Dreams from the kingdom of darkness communicate lies and deception in order to bring the dreamer into the bondage of fear, sickness and evil. They project the enemy's plan and

our response is to reject the lies through prayers and affirm the truth by prayerfully acknowledging our victory in Christ.

DISCERNING THE ORIGIN OF DREAMS

There are two primary elements that are needed in discerning the source of dreams; they are,

1. The inward witness:

The inward witness is the activity of the Holy Spirit in your heart. The Spirit bears witness with our spirits that we are the sons of God, (Romans 8:16).

The inward witness is not necessarily a voice. When you got saved, you didn't exactly hear a voice thundering from heaven, "Bravo, now you are born again."

It is best described as "The knowing of revelation". You just know there's something about this dream, though you may not be able to tell how you knew it. This is how you can differentiate between a vain dream and a dream that comes with a message. The inward witness helps us to filter dreams; separating chaffs from wheat. Sometimes, you wake up and upon your waking moment, you just know in your heart what the dream is saying and where it came from; this is the inward witness at work. Sometimes, you will know it's a dream from God, however, the interpretation is not certain yet and there will be a burden on your heart to prayerfully seek God to understand the interpretation.

2. The witness of scriptures:

In the mouth of two or three witnesses, the truth shall be established. The witness of the Scripture is the most valid testimony for judging anything received as a prophetic revelation; dreams, visions, trances, or prophecies.

Revelation 19:10

“And I fell at his feet to worship him. And he said unto me, see thou do it not: I am thy fellow servant, and of thy brethren that have the testimony of Jesus: worship God: for the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.”

If a dream is prophetic (inspired by God), it will definitely correspond with what Jesus is saying or has said in His word concerning you. If a dream says something contrary to what Jesus has said and has done for us through His death, burial and resurrection, then it's not from God. The place of Scriptures in relating with dreams is extensively discussed in the chapter titled “Dreams and Scriptures”.

CHAPTER 2

REMEMBERING YOUR DREAMS

1 Samuel 28:6

"And when Saul enquired of the LORD, the LORD answered him not, neither by dreams, nor by Urim, nor by prophets."

When you talk down on dreams and you treat your dreams lightly; you cannot maximize your prophetic journey with God. God is not boring. He loves adventures and loves to take us through adventurous paths to the end that we may become more intimate with Him.

Walking through a dream during interpretation is like walking through a maze with interconnected channels, it is designed to make us seekers of God. Dream interpretation is usually fun and adventurous if we lean on the Holy Spirit to help us.

Dreams from God's Spirit need God's Spirit for accurate understanding and interpretation. Some dreams are literal, others are complex, but all can be understood through the Holy Spirit, the revealer of secret things, the giver of God-encounter dreams.

Averagely, men have about four dreams when they sleep at night, some or all of which they remember. For some people, their dream fades away as they wake up. However, spiritual intelligence can help us to become better dream catchers. The understanding of how a dream comes and how men receive dreams will help us to know what to do to become better dream catchers. By 'Dream catcher', I mean a person who can catch the revelation

God is giving him through the realm of dreams and remember it in details upon waking up. Just as visions, dreams are prophetic tools or channels through which God gives us His blessings and revelations. A dream is a prophetic tool for accessing the heart of the Father. When God shows you a dream, you see this with the eyes of your heart or mind just as you see a vision. When a man sleeps, his spirit and his subconscious mind are awake and active while his conscious mind remains passive. Your creative subconscious mind is the realm that captures the memory of your dreams.

God can give you an encounter in your dream, where you're not just shown something, but your spirit man actively participates in it. Have you ever had a dream where when you woke up, your body was vibrating in response to God's presence and power that you fellowshiped with, in the dream? That was an encounter with God, an event that your spirit man participated in. It is as though God is showing you something on a screen and at the same time you were part of those acting the script.

Some people have the special ability for dreams, even before they got saved, they had dreams that came to pass. Whether there's a special ability or not, we all can train ourselves to become dreamers just as we can train ourselves to exercise the gift of prophecy. Those that have the special gift of dreams do often remember their dream. For them, the same ability that made them have the dream helps them to remember it. Although, not everyone finds it that easy. Some have dreams but hardly remember.

Job 20:8

“He shall fly away as a dream, and shall not be found: yea, he shall be chased away as a vision of the night.”

Dreams can fade, nevertheless, we don't want to lose revelations and the word of the Lord coming to us through dreams. The stronger our spirit man, the better it is to catch and retain dreams. Hence, the need to build a strong spirit through studying of the word, praying in the Spirit and obedience to God. Your dream realm is meant to be a place where God interacts with you in an intimate way devoid of distractions from the externals. No one can enjoy intimate relationship with God without living in the Spirit. Living and walking in the Spirit helps us to enjoy unending fellowship with God both in our wakeful and sleeping state. One of the reasons people have meaningless dreams and also don't remember their dreams is due to a lifestyle of walking in the flesh.

God is Spirit and He said those who worship Him should do so in Spirit and truth. As a believer, the totality of your life is expected to produce a sound of worship to God; including your dream realm. You cannot live 95% of your life in the flesh during the day and expect to have spiritual God-given dreams at night, except by God's sovereignty. A weak spirit will not be able to capture the full import of spiritual interactions. A weak spirit will not be able to carry the fruits of that interaction through to the mind, where the man can process and make meaning out of the experience.

A strong spirit, on the other hand, will be able to capture the full import of spiritual interaction both in dreams and visions. That does not mean that a man maturing in the spirit cannot have fading dreams once in a while. But if a man consistently forgets his dream, then he should work on building a strong spirit.

How do we build a strong spirit? A major way is to walk in righteousness and to have a strong prayer life, with praying in other tongues as a major

prayer language, feed on the Word, meditate on the Word, make it your daily bread. Grow some weight by feeding and feeding again.

POSITIONING YOURSELF FOR GOD-INSPIRED DREAMS

Let's briefly look at how to position ourselves for receiving God's blessings through dreams. We can receive the word of the Lord, have visitations of angels, saints, and other awesome encounters through dreams.

Psalms 17:3

“Thou hast proved mine heart; thou hast visited me in the night;”

Psalms 127:2

“It is vain for you to rise early, to retire late, to eat the bread of anxious labours— For He gives [blessings] to His beloved even in his sleep.”

Meditate on Scriptures like these ones above before you sleep and expect a heavenly visitation in your dream; an encounter, a divine revelation. Meditation opens the doorway of your heart to the supernatural dimension; as you mediate on scriptures and sleep off, your gateways will be opened to heavenly kingdom realm for godly interactions.

Another way we position ourselves for God-inspired dreams is by prayers. Pray extensively in tongues before you sleep. What this will achieve is a stirring in your spirit and activation of your spiritual receptors to catch God's revelation via dreams.

Furthermore, verbally make declarations, “Tonight, I dedicate my dream realm to God as a place of encounters and divine spiritual revelations. I receive God's tangible blessings. I receive directions, I receive God's counsel for my life tonight”.

This is not what we do one night, it must become a practice, a spiritual routine. Until your joy is full, this is a routine you shouldn't stop. God can sovereignly give us encounters and show us revelations through dreams, and we can ask him for them too. After all, in Christ, He has freely given us all things and He gave us a blank check for withdrawal in Matthew 7:7 says, *“Ask and you shall receive, seek and you will find, knock and it shall be opened unto you.”*

Another exercise we can engage in to prepare ourselves to receive from God in our dream realm is worship and praise. Engage in worshipping the Lord before you sleep. Through worship and praise, we enter His gates and courts, and we come before His presence with singing where worldly weights fall off from our hearts. (Psalms 100:2, 4). Worship makes our spirit light for soaring and ascension in the spirit. As we spend considerable time worshipping before we sleep, we open up our spiritual senses, activating our spirit receptors saying “Oh my soul, it's time to soar with God.”

PRACTICAL STEPS TO REMEMBER YOUR DREAMS

1. Have a strong desire to remember your dreams

Exercise the strength of your will through faith in Jesus and expect to remember your dream every time you have one. Never accept the identity of being a forgetful dreamer. And from that place of heart, make declarations.

“In the name of Jesus, with my spirit and my soul I interact with God over the night and the memory of my interaction stays with me. The Bible says in Mark 11:24 – whatsoever I desire when I pray, I should believe I have received and I shall have it. I decree and I believe that from now henceforth my dreams bring messages from God, I understand and I remember my dream. I decree and I declare, I am not a forgetful dreamer, the memory of my dream stays with me at all times.”

2. Consecrate your dream receptors to God

Make these declarations;

“My heart and my mind are consecrated to God by the blood of Jesus. I apply the blood of Jesus on the doorpost of my imagination. I am not given to futility in my dream realm. I ordain my dream realm as a place of engagement with God. My mind, heart, and memory are quickened to retain my interactions.”

Hebrews 9:13-14

“For if the blood of bulls and of goats, and the ashes of an heifer sprinkling the unclean, sanctifieth to the purifying of the flesh: How much more shall the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without spot to God, purge your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?”

The blood of Jesus is a very powerful weapon, it can cleanse our hearts and minds from futility and vain dreams, and quicken it for catching godly revelations.

3. Act in faith

Don't sleep without a journal by your side, knowing that God will give you a revelation at night and you don't want to lose it. Help yourself by your readiness to note down the things God shows you. Recording your dream is one of the channels to remember it, because this helps you to walk through the dream again, capturing more details along the way.

Dreams can fly away, but we should do all we can to trap our God-given dreams. Cultivate the habit of Journaling your dreams, it's a sign that you honour the Lord and what He has to say.

4. Don't immediately stand up from bed

One of the basic exercises for retaining the memory of your dream is to remain on the bed for the first few minutes after waking up. And consciously meditate around the dream you had, if they seem to be fading, pray in tongues quietly in a posture of stillness. Even when an alarm or phone call wakes you, learn not to abruptly jump out of bed. The act of remaining still on the bed helps the memory of the dream to consolidate in your conscious mind. Also avoid what will make you abruptly jump out of bed, like very loud alarm. Set the volume of your alarm moderately.

5. Think about the dream through the day

As your day proceeds, consciously engage the dream in your thought process, with the intention of restoring the fading memory. Once and again, stir your memory by thinking about the dream, as you do so, more details of the dream will be gathered in your conscious mind.

JOURNALING YOUR DREAM

In journaling your dream, write everything you can, don't leave out any detail. The detail you think is insignificant may be the very key for the interpretation. There are grey dreams; where colours are not obvious, but if your dream is colourful, then note the colours you see. Note the emotion, numbers, places, feelings, etc.

The details will make the interpretation more precise and comprehensive. Sometimes when you have a series of dreams on the same night, they may be a sequence of the same message or God passing across the same message to you in different ways. Note down everything you can remember. Your dreams are like parts of a jigsaw puzzle that God is arranging to make your life beautiful. The dreams you have, the prophecies you receive, your inward witness, the visions you see, revelation knowledge from the Bible, your prayers and the teachings that blessed you; are all connected.

If you can understand this, you will have peace in following the Lord and trusting him in the case of forgotten dreams. That you forgot the details of a God encounter dream doesn't mean that you didn't receive what God gave you, you did. A dream you forget will return to you by God's mercies, but it may come in a different form, whether through another dream or the scripture, prophecy, or any other way; that message will return to you. Trust the Lord.

He knows how best to communicate His heart to His children. God knows when you didn't catch the message that He sent to you through a dream. The same word will return to you because it's still around you, it is the kingdom's

principle that a matter is seen as established when it has been witnessed two or three times or witnessed through two or three channel (2 Corinthians 13:1).

Have you ever been in that position where at different places and times, people gave you the same prophetic word? The reason is this, that word is still in your cloud, it's in your atmosphere in the spirit. Your heart hasn't fully absorbed it, and anyone with a sensitive spiritual receptor can pick it up and prophesy to you. Likewise, with God-given dreams, it's the word of the Lord coming to you in audio-visual form. Until your heart has received it fully, it remains in your cloud, it keeps coming until you receive it. That's the long-suffering of God toward us.

If you are not a dreamer. Don't beat yourself up, you can desire to dream for more adventures in God, but you are never inferior to those who dream. The word of the Lord has myriad ways it can come to you. People that dream most are those called into the prophetic ministry or those that are inclined more to the prophetic by ordination, than other streams of expressions of God's grace.

Numbers 12:6

“And he said, hear now my words: If there be a prophet among you, I the LORD will make myself known unto him in a vision, and will speak unto him in a dream.”

REVISITING YOUR DREAM

You can re-visit a dream you once had, also, you can have a dream that someone else had.

Daniel 2:5, 19

“The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, the thing is gone from me: if ye will not make known unto me the dream, with the interpretation thereof, ye shall be cut in pieces, and your houses shall be made a dunghill. Then was the secret revealed unto Daniel in a night vision. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven.”

Here, Daniel dreamt the same dream the King had and also received its interpretation. When you're awake, you can revisit the dream you once had, through the realm of vision. How do you that? Meditation!

God can be showing you a prophecy about your future in a dream but you feel there is more to this dream. If you sleep back, you can't guarantee that you won't have another dream entirely, instead, stay up, pray in tongues gently and mediate around that word of the Lord that came to you in audio-visual form. Use that word as a doorway, to come into spiritual sight. You can see a thing in a dream (night vision) and wake up to continue the sight in visions, through the spiritual exercise of meditation.

It can be learned by practice and done through dependence on the Holy Spirit. This will be easy if, in your place of fellowship with the Holy Spirit, you have learned how to stir yourself to catch spiritual revelation, through praying in tongues as you engage God in your heart – the gate of your spirit.

God can start a conversation with you in a dream and you continue the communication in your wakeful state.

Lastly, dreams are tools for receiving from God but you don't have to be asleep before you hear God. Walk in the spirit and feed on the scriptures, His word will always come to you. However, don't leave your night seasons to chance; maximize it, own it by consciously yielding it to God for godly encounters.

CHAPTER 3

ENGAGING YOUR DREAMWORLD

Dreams sometimes project to us, our engagement in the spirit world. They reveal our stance, warfare, interactions and even what God has settled about us in the realm of the spirit.

Everybody dreams; saints, the people of the world, idol worshippers, etc. Everybody dreams because every man has a spirit that can receive communications from the spirit world and a mind that can project man's thoughts back to him as dreams. Visions and dreams are not sole properties of the believers in Christ. They are common to men and the realm of men.

In the Bible, good people dreamt, so did bad people. Pharaoh, Joseph (Son of Jacob), Jacob, Daniel, Nebuchadnezzar, Joseph (Husband of Mary) and a host of others had dreams. However, a man that is born again has an advantage over his dream realm, compared to the man who doesn't know the Lord.

Dreams can be projections from the spirit world which your human spirit captures and transmits to your subconscious mind as images and sounds. In this chapter our focus is on spiritual dreams. Demonic dreams are projections from the dark world of the spirit that communicates falsehood and bondage through images, symbols, and sounds. God-encounter dreams come from the communication of the heavenly kingdom realm. Spiritual dreams and visions from God are usually stewarded by angels to men.

Revelation 1:1

“The Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave unto him, to shew unto his servants, things which must shortly come to pass; and he sent and signified it by his angel unto his servant John.”

The book of revelation came to John by signification or demonstration of the angel of the Lord Jesus Christ. The visions he saw by which he captured the details of the book of revelation were demonstrations of angels. This doesn't mean he wasn't really in heaven as he recorded, but the angelic ministry played a major role in his coming into those prophetic sights. Portal angels grant access into gateways and doors in the Kingdom realm of heaven bringing men into heavenly places in God's will (Ephesians 1:3). And there are revelation angels that steward revelation and communicate them to us in sights and sounds via dreams and visions.

In Mathew 4, we read about the temptations of Jesus by the devil;

Matthew 4:3-11

“And when the tempter came to him, he said, if thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread. But he answered and said, it is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.

Then the devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple, and saith unto him, if thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear

thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone. Jesus said unto him, it is written again, thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.

Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them; And saith unto him, all these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me. Then saith Jesus unto him, get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve. Then the devil leaveth him, and, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.”

Jesus was in the wilderness throughout the temptation period. He never left there. But the Bible says, the devil took him into the holy city and set him on a pinnacle of the temple. How did this happen? It was in the spirit realm and it was captured by Jesus' visionary experience.

Again, he took Jesus into an exceeding high mountain and show him all the kingdoms of the world. There's no mountain in the world where you will stand and see all the kingdoms of the world in one glance. Not even Mount Everest. Again, that's a visionary experience that Jesus had where the devil showed him several things.

The Bible says after the devil left; angels came to minister to him. All the while, they were around, but then, Jesus gained the victory unaided. Note that Jesus, the devil, and the angels were all there and active in the spirit world. If Jesus had failed in the spirit realm encounter with the devil, there will be no excuse for an occurrence of such cataclysmic proportion. The

reason is that, spirit realm encounters are real. They happened. Blessed be God that Jesus overcame the tempter, our accuser.

SPIRITUAL DREAMS ARE REAL

Spiritual dreams from God are real. King Solomon had a dream where he asked God for wisdom and he woke up wise and rich. Yet, someone wants to tell you that dreams are not real. If you had a victory in your dream, it happened. If you had a seeming defeat you must treat it as a lie of the devil and superimpose the truth of your victory in Christ over the situation. To treat dreams of defeat that demand your response in faith as nothing, may open you up to defeat in your live circumstances. Sometimes, God permits us to have such dreams in order to redeem us from demonically planned defeat, and our accurate response establishes our victory in Christ our Lord.

One certain afternoon, I was sleeping and I had a dream. In the dream, a witch bit me on my palm and was eating and chewing on my flesh. I woke up with pain at that spot. I immediately reversed the effect of that reality that just happened in the spirit realm. I prayed and declared the word of God to affirm my victory in Christ against dark powers, the pain left and I was fine.

The spirit realm is real and once a thing happens there; it will play out on earth unless the believer takes action to stop it. I am an African and we know that demonic powers are real in Africa. When I got born again, I was so full of courage and boldness in the name of Jesus. I heard that demonic masquerades appear to people to beat and torment them in their dream. I was so curious, and in my immaturity, I would go to bed, praying and

pleading with God to allow masquerade to come to my dream so I could manifest the power of Christ in me. Eventually, they came and I dealt with them.

If as a believer who walks in God's ways, you have a dream of defeat, wake up, pray in tongues and affirm your victory in Christ through confessions, sleep again, and make sure you whip that demon. Know that you can culture yourself to always have wins in your dream world, you can culture yourself to always have victory. You can culture yourself to respond adequately to things in your dream realm. Your dream realm has a way of telling you that you need to pray some more or understand redemption truth better, because, you can be very prayerful, and in your dream still be defeated if you haven't stored up God's word in your heart.

Your dream realm is strongly connected to your subconscious mind, and on a general note, you'll respond to things in your dream from that memory database (subconscious). The spirit realm is a real realm and we must train ourselves to be active participants, one who knows how to enforce and disallow things through prayers. The realm of the spirit is the happening place. What we see happening on the earth are the effects of things concluded in the spirit.

Don't leave the spirit realm to witches, wizards, necromancers, and workers of darkness. The Kingdom realm of heaven which is a spiritual zone is your primary habitat and you are seated with Christ in heavenly places far above principalities and powers (Ephesians 2:5-7). Discerning spirits and their operations will be easy by the Holy Spirit when you begin to pay attention to the Holy Spirit and the Word, seeking to know what God is

doing. Stay on the Word of God and fill your heart with the Word, soon it will become your portal for visionary experiences and night visions.

WHAT IF I WAS ATTACKED IN MY DREAM?

If your dream projects attack or defeat, do this...

Get scriptures that affirm your victory in Christ in that area and pray in the spirit using those scriptures as your prayer focus and weapon. Pray from faith until you are convinced that you have won just as the Scripture has said. A defeat in a dream is not a defeat in life unless you permit it. Whatever you see in your dream can either be nullified or established by your faith filled prayers.

The devil usually comes to sell lies to people, in their dreams. He shows people that their marriage will fail, their loved ones will die, their business will fold up, their ministry will not work, they will fall sick, their lives will end in a bad way just like their parents, etc. Don't buy his lies, whatever you see in your dream that doesn't look like what the scripture says about you, is a lie, a false testimony that should be rejected and nullified through prayers. The only thing you should accept and believe is what the scripture says about you.

Someone called me some time ago and said she dreamt that I died. In the dream, some people came around saying that I was dead, there was no life in me and there's no need to pray for me. But she said, she prayed and I returned to life. When she told me the dream, I didn't freak out an inch. I prayed with her affirming our victory in Christ, standing on the word. Although, when she narrated the dream, I knew in my spirit, that my image

was used as a symbol in the dream. Two days after, she called me and said the similitude of the dream she had, played out with her mother, but glory to God she didn't die.

If you have a vision and a dream that doesn't align with the word, don't take it. Also, be aware that your response to things in the dream world has something to say about your understanding and faith in the word of God and your strength in the spirit.

After praying about a negative dream, ensure you don't stay bothered. Know that you have the authority by God to have the last say and establish what stands. The dream is a speaking; however, the Bible says, you will say a thing and it shall come to pass that light may shine upon your path. This means that if you have a dark dream that seeks to influence the course of your life with evil, you can turn the tide around by praying to God and decreeing the written word to nullify what the enemy is projecting and establish what Christ has already finished. If you do this, the light of victory will abundantly shine upon your path.

Job 22:27-28

“Thou shalt make thy prayer unto him, and he shall hear thee, and thou shalt pay thy vows. Thou shalt also decree a thing, and it shall be established unto thee: and the light shall shine upon thy ways.”

CHAPTER 4

DREAMS AND SCRIPTURES

Man can connect to the realm of the spirit, because of his makeup. The makeup of man is spirit, soul, and body. With the spirit, man connects to the spirit realm. With the soul, he connects to the sensual realm of will, intellect, emotions, and choice. With the body, he connects to the physical earthly dimension. The realm of the spirit is not up there or down there, it is around us in another dimension of reality. We engage and connect with it daily whether we are aware or not.

Praying in tongues helps to stir our spirit so we can become sensitive to the spirit, it also heightens our spiritual consciousness. One of the results of consistently praying in tongues is that, it opens the channels of our spirits to the Holy Spirit, and this will make us enjoy spiritual communications like the inward witness, prophecy, dreams, and visions.

Now, because the spirit realm is wide and it's a place where opposite realities coexist, God didn't leave us without a guide for spirit realm engagement. To maximize the usage of the spiritual channels of dreams, visions and prophecy, we must know the guide and the boundaries of operations God has put in place for us.

John 16:13

“Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.”

The Holy Ghost is our compass and guide for spirit realm engagement and the Scripture is our map that defines our boundaries. Compass is used for telling the direction to take when journeying with a map. It shows us the true north; without it, we cannot adequately travel by a map in an unknown land. Maps are used to show directions and mark boundaries. The Scripture is God's word that shows us directions and set the boundaries for us in spirit realm engagement. To maximize spiritual encounters, we must know the place of the Holy Spirit - our guide and the Scripture - our map. We are not bound by the letters that kill, however, we are bound by the Spirit of the Word and the truth of the Bible that gives life.

2 Corinthians 3:6

“Who also hath made us able ministers of the new testament; not of the letter, but of the spirit: for the letter killeth, but the spirit giveth life.”

The Word of God is the sovereign authority and the Bible is Spirit inspired. Although, we are not bound by the letters of the Word that kills, but the Spirit of the Word that gives life; yet, the doorway to the Spirit of the Word is through the letters of the Word. Hence the need to honour the Bible as the book of sovereign authority. We also need to honour the word in context as it is written. A man that has no honour for the Scripture will meddle with dark spirits in the name of new revelation.

2 Timothy 3:16-17

“All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness, that the man of God

may be perfect, thoroughly furnished unto all good works”.

Our perfection is in walking in the truth of God's word as revealed in the scriptures; and all scripture, not just the New Testament is given by God's inspiration. Paul said something profound in Galatians 1.

Galatians 1:8-9

“But though we, or an angel from heaven, preach any other gospel unto you than that which we have preached unto you, let him be accursed. As we said before, so say I now again, if any man preaches any other gospel unto you than that ye have received, let him be accursed.”

Paul is exalting the word of the Lord that the Galatians have received, he showed them that there's no new gospel that's apart from what has been preached to them. In other words, by the Spirit of God, men can come and expound on the gospel they have received, but if any man comes to teach them anything different or if any angel comes in vision realm to say something contrary, let such be accursed.

This is Paul giving them a measuring rod for judging what people preach and their encounters, and this measuring rod is the word of the Lord, which is the gospel that they have received. That same word is what we have received in the Scripture delivered to us.

THE GOSPEL

The gospel is the good news of the death, burial, resurrection and ascension of Christ for the redemption of man from sin, sickness, death and eternal damnation. The gospel is the foundation of our faith, it's our access to the heavenly kingdom realm and its endless possibilities. The gospel of Christ is our lens now, it is our filter and sense of judgement for all things.

The gospel of Christ is the power of God unto salvation to them that believe — Romans 1:16. The power of God that is revealed in and through us as we engage in the things of the spirit is premised upon our understanding of the gospel. Here is what John has to say;

1 John 4:1-3

“Beloved, believe not every spirit, but try the spirits whether they are of God...”

Spiritual dreams and visions come by the operations of spirits. Dreams and visions are ways through which the human spirit traps the communication coming from the realm of the Spirit. To believe what a dream is saying is to believe the spirit that inspired it, hence the admonition on not believing every spirit can also imply not believing every dream until they have been proven.

Any night vision or dream that contradicts the truth of Jesus' coming in the flesh (*the gospel*) is from the antichrist. Antichrist here represents any spirit that operates contrary to Christ. Our understanding of the gospel must be solid so that our judgment of spiritual things can be accurate.

1 John 4:2-3

“Hereby know ye the Spirit of God: Every spirit that confesseth that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is of God: And every spirit that confesseth not that Jesus Christ is come in the flesh is not of God: and this is that spirit of antichrist, whereof ye have heard that it should come; and even now already is it in the world.”

Use the Scripture as a judge to prove what you perceive the Holy Spirit is saying when interpreting dreams, because dreams do not come to confirm scriptures, it is the other way around. Scriptures are available, waiting to confirm God’s voice in your encounters. The Scripture is of higher authority than any dream a man can have. If God-given dreams are Holy Spirit inspired, it will not contradict the Spirit inspired written word that God has given to draw the pattern and set the boundary for our life experiences, in God’s will on earth. Dreams, visions, prophecies are channels through which God speaks, but the message they bring must also be made to pass through the sieve of the scripture; more precisely - the gospel of Christ. When you hear the Gospel of Christ, this doesn’t just mean the New Testament. There's the gospel of Christ in Psalms and Proverbs. Even the Prophets and the Law testified about Him. The same Spirit that inspires the dreams, visions, and prophecies is the Spirit of Prophecy that testifies about Christ.

Revelation 19:10

“And I fell at his feet to worship him. And he said unto me, see thou do it not: I am thy fellow servant, and of thy brethren that have the testimony of Jesus:

worship God: for the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.”

The Spirit that gives dream, vision, and prophecy is the testimony of Christ. Hence, when you are judging dreams and seeking understanding for interpretation, position yourself to listen to what the Spirit of prophecy – the Holy Spirit, is saying. Remember, He will always testify about Christ in agreement with what is already written.

If you have a dream that projects that you are under attack or under evil circumstances or reveals the devil’s plan, reject the witness by taking on the shield of faith by your understanding of scriptures, the declaration of your faith and confession or acknowledging of every good thing written about the redeemed in the Word. If the dream projects God’s plan in alignment with scriptural blessings, prayerfully establish what you have seen by declaring the vision over yourself and rejoicing over it. If it reveals God’s plan for your future, write the vision and consistently read it to yourself and keep it alive in your meditation until it is born.

Summarily, don’t believe whatever you see or hear that contradicts what is written in the Bible in the light of the finished Word of Christ. If a dream pushes you to the place of fear, then you have believed the wrong thing – what the enemy is saying about you. Go back to the word of God and feed your faith in God. Always remember that faith in God through Jesus His Son is the victory that overcomes the world.

This is how you judge the dreams you have about yourself and other people. Don’t share a dream that projects a negative outcome in a way that scares God’s people. Even if it is a warning dream, it must be done in an edifying way that inspires faith in God not fear of what the devil can do.

If someone comes to you to say, 'I saw a vision about you that you died'. Is that what Jesus is saying about you in the Scriptures? No. Therefore, you have nothing to fear if you are walking in the ways of God. Psalm 91 says with long life will He satisfy you and show you His salvation.

When you have a dream that you will fail a course or have an extra year in school, or your husband will leave you, or a loved one will suffer evil, do not accept that testimony. Stand on the word of the Lord and pray against it. The way you relate to such a dream is to not fear. For God has not given you the spirit of fear. After praying about the dream, ensure you live according to God's principles and wisdom, remember faith without works is dead. Don't just pray, do right and live right.

Also, don't treat it as though it doesn't matter. You may not have sustained the level of consciousness of the truth that wields enough spiritual energy to avert it without you praying. Pray against it from a place of victory. How? by affirming the testimony of Christ that contradicts what your dream projects. I believe God sometimes permits us to have such dreams so we can disallow them from coming to pass. Remember that what you allow on earth is what stands around you (Mat 18:18-19).

God reveals to redeem; God doesn't reveal to entertain. He doesn't reveal to make us feel good. He doesn't reveal to torment either. He reveals to tell us either to allow it or disallow it. The reason for that is, God wants your active participation in the Spirit, He doesn't want to do everything for you. He wants you to participate.

Also, don't judge dreams culturally; saying, "If I eat water melon and salad in the dream, it is evil. If I see a cock, it means barrenness. If someone

gives me coconut, it means blah...blah...blah”. Shun cultural interpretation of dreams and tune to scriptural Spirit-inspired interpretation.

DREAMS AND MYSTERIES

With respect to spiritual things, what some people call mystery is what others call plain; the difference between the two group is intimacy with God, which is a prerequisite for understanding how God speaks. See what our Lord Jesus said;

Matthew 13:11

“He answered and said unto them, because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given.”

There are mysteries in the Kingdom, but you have what it takes to understand them all. Although they are mysteries, to you, they won't be. You have what it takes to understand what others call mysterious. Why are they mysteries to those who call them mysteries? They are mysteries because of the people's state of heart, a rebellious heart is a veiled heart, a repentant heart purified by faith in God is an unveiled heart.

Matthew 13:13-17

“Therefore, speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand. And in them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, by hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall

see, and shall not perceive: For this people's heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes they have closed; lest at any time they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and should understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them. But blessed are your eyes, for they see: and your ears, for they hear. For verily I say unto you, that many prophets and righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.”

The mysteries of the kingdom are not hidden from us who are in the kingdom. When you got born again, your eyes became open, and now you can see the Kingdom. John 3 vs 3 *“Unless a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God”*.

By the new birth, you now have what it takes to see the Kingdom, you now have the life of God and the Spirit of God by which you can understand the mysteries of the Kingdom. Jesus said to them, there are people that will see but in seeing they will see not, they will hear but in hearing they will hear not. Jesus told the disciples, the reason mystery remains a mystery to these people is because, their hearts are waxed gross and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes are closed, lest at any time they should see with their eyes and hear with their ears and should understand and be converted.

Now, we see that the basic reason mysteries remain mysteries to men is because their hearts are shut towards God.

Revelation 3:20

“I stand at the door of your heart and knock, if any man hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in and dine with him”.

The Lord dines with us by His word; revelation and truth. Jesus stands at the door of men’s hearts, it is those who open to him that are brought into fellowship with His mysteries, where His secrets are unveiled to them. Anyone who is born again can understand the mysteries of the kingdom. However, it is not everyone who is born again that opens their heart to the Lord. Jesus stands and knocks once and again at the door of our heart, not for relationship because we already have that with Him, but for fellowship. Do we usually open to him to come in and fellowship with us and dine with us by the reason of his truth and revelations?

One of the reasons why some of us still have dreams that are mysterious to us is that, our hearts are still shut towards God in terms of heart to heart fellowship where we are demanded to be naked before Him. The more we fellowship with the Lord intimately, the more our heart gets opened to him, and the more we begin to see the things of the kingdom as plainly as they are. What was previously seen as mysterious will begin to make sense because we now see by the light of Christ that we fellowship with through open hearts and unveiled faces.

About those who are not in the Kingdom, Jesus said, “Their heart is waxed gross” what does that mean? It means that they have a heart posture that is not ready to change. However, they want to see just for seeing sake and hear for hearing’s sake, whereas, they are not ready to apply the truth to their hearts or change their ways and become converted, that Jesus may heal them.

Matthew 13:11, 18

“He answered and said unto them, because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given..... Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.”

Jesus said to His disciples “To you, it has been given to know the mysteries of the Kingdom”, however, He continued speaking to them in mysteries or parables. He just said, “They have what it takes to understand the mysteries of the Kingdom”. Howbeit, this didn’t make Jesus change His pattern of teaching in mysteries. He continued speaking to them in mysteries and He continued interpreting it to them that they may mature, until they no longer need interpretation, when they will hear mystery as plain speech. Because we have the privilege of access to God through faith, every mysterious dream will be made plain to us as we look to the Lord for light.

1 Corinthians 2:7

“But we speak the wisdom of God in a mystery, even the hidden wisdom, which God ordained before the world unto our glory.”

The more our heart is opened and yielded to God, the more we don't hear in riddles but plainly. God gives us dreams in parables to draw our hearts to him in greater degree of intimacy; in the place of fellowship everything becomes plain. Everything the heavenly kingdom realm brings to you is to make you see and seek the King and His kingdom more intimately.

This resource in your hand is to draw you to a place of deeper intimacy where you can hear God's mysteries spoken to you plainly from an open heart. And where you can learn God's language and His ways so you can help others hear God plainly through His mysteries spoken to them.

PROPHECY

God is raising interpreters of mysteries! Men who know God's ways. God is raising interpreters of God's ways. God is raising interpreters of God's oracles. God is raising interpreters of God's movements on the earth. God is raising interpreters.

Men who know His ways. Men who know His language. Men who can read His heart. Men who can hear His unspoken words. Men who can hear Him. Men whose hearts are opened to behold His many wonders. Men with unveiled faces who will look into his glory.

God is raising interpreters of His laws. Interpreters of His dealings. Men who will not darken counsel with words without knowledge.

The Josephs are rising! The Daniels are here! I am talking about you. It's you I am describing. You are that Joseph; you are that Daniel.

I see God releasing the spirit of counsel upon His children.

You will see with open eyes. Like Moses, you will know His ways. You will be a prophet of His face, for He will speak to you face to face as a man speaks to his friend.

You will know my secret, and I will hide nothing from you. You will see my steps on the path, you will hear my voice in the storm, you will know my way in the wilderness, you will see me leading you on the way.

The scripture will begin to open to you because God is giving you a new set of eyes to see the kingdom. You will see the kingdom from the pages of the book. You will see it just as it is.

God is taking away the mentality of shadows. He is giving you the mentality to see plainly as a son in the Kingdom. God is calling us to partake of his nature of Omniscience. "I gave you my anointing to know all things. Share in my Omniscience".

Nothing will be hard for you to understand from today. A new realm of sight entirely is being imparted. Not only will you be able to interpret all dreams, but you will also interpret all visions, hard sentences, hard matters. I will even cause you to interpret my handwriting on the wall.

Oh, Glory to Jesus!

2019

Livingstone O.

CHAPTER 5

DREAMS AND PROPHECY

Prophecy is an inspired utterance in a known language that communicates the thoughts, words, counsel, and will of God.

1 Corinthians 14:3

“But he that prophesieth speaketh unto men to edification, and exhortation, and comfort.”

Here, Paul mentioned three blessings that prophecy brings; edification, exhortation, and comfort. These three captures the forthtelling expression of prophecy. There are two expressions of prophecy, they are; forthtelling and foretelling.

Forthtelling: Speaking forth as inspired by the Holy Spirit. You speak to edify, encourage and exhort.

Foretelling: This is the revelation of what is to come, the prediction of the future.

In this chapter, we will be focusing on the expression of prophecy that is captured in foretelling; the revelation of what is to come, the prediction of the future ahead of you. We will be looking at this in the light of dream, since prophetic witnesses from the Spirit, about the future can be received through dreams.

Jeremiah 29:11

“For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, saith the LORD, thoughts of peace, and not of evil, to give you an expected end.”

God is constantly seeking ways by which He can bring us into the awareness of His thoughts about us; His thoughts for our lives, our future, our destiny and purpose on earth. We have established that dreams are channels by which God communicates to us, channels through which God sows the seeds of His thoughts for our destiny into our hearts. God is not trying to create a future for us now, He is not trying to figure out a plan for our future. Your future is already figured out. I mean, He has it figured out, completely. All things are settled already and established in His heart, for He is the author and finisher of your life and destiny.

THE CONTEMPLATIONS OF GOD

(Here is my attempt to paint a picture of how and what God thinks about you, I most certainly know that His thoughts are more glorious than what I can ever pen down, however, I hope this piece edifies you).

Right from the time that you were a child, God has got his eyes on you, he has been seeking ways to bring you into the awareness of His thoughts for you. He thinks of the great things He has in mind for you. Not only the things He has planned for you but also the things He has ordained for you. He thinks about how He made you a masterpiece of art, a perfect product of the craftsmanship of divinity, a tapestry of His living thoughts and counsel knitted into a beautiful life, which He ordained for you and called your destiny.

He thinks about what He has framed you for, and He is happy with the perfection and excellence of His works; which is you. Not only did He place you here, but He has also placed everything you will ever need here. He placed them here before He placed you here, just like He did for Adam.

He thinks about your childhood, how He delivered you from the same thing that killed many of your peers. He thinks about how He has preserved you from death on multiple occasions and your soul from destruction. He thinks about his loving-kindness over you. Anytime He thinks about you, He goes... "How excellent are my works, I looked at everything I created, and oh, they are good?"

He then shifts in His thought and focuses on His eternal counsel for creation, He thinks about how sin messed up everything and how sin gained entrance through man. But He smiles when He calls to remembrance, His son Jesus and His death to bring redemption and restoration of all things, beginning with the man! And He goes, "Everything must be redeemed. Everything must be restored. The price has been paid. My son died, He must get the full reward for His sacrifice, everything must be restored."

At this point, He thinks of His plan and brings to focus how everyone whom He sends to the earth is to find meaning for their life in His Son. For the eternal plan is this; through man, creation went into disarray and through man, the order will be restored. Then, He looks at you again and says, "This is exactly why I sent you here, I have a place for you in the restoration program. This is what I had in mind when I sent you here. My plan is this, as you unite with my son Jesus, you are enabled to see and empowered to play your part in my eternal counsel".

And God is thinking, there is a good work I have ordained you for. This is what I was thinking when I framed you, I framed you with a specific plan in mind. I have a slot for you in my restoration program on the earth, you have a part in it. You are ordained for good works. That's what I made you for. I made you for something unique. My purpose for you is the good works I preordained you for in line with my eternal plan for creation.”

Ephesians 2:10

“For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.”

Since you were born, God has been on a quest to bring you into the awareness of His thoughts for you, and to enable you to do what He has foreordained you for. For this reason, He got you saved, filled you with His Spirit, sends His servants to you, sends his saints to prophesy to you, highlights certain portion of the Scripture that feels personal to you, His Spirit bear witness to your heart to confirm His will and He even shows you visions and gives you prophetic dreams.

Many saints who I know personally have captured the thoughts of God about their lives and future through dreams, those are prophetic dreams, destiny revealing dreams.

PROPHETIC DREAMS

Prophetic dreams are not vain dreams or products of our subconscious mind and imagination, they are messages from heaven. God gives us prophetic dreams to;

- Bear witness to God's thoughts for your life.
- Impart awareness of purpose and destiny.
- Reveal God's plan and will for your life.
- Reveal your calling and ministry.

Some people have had dreams where they consistently see themselves in another country. A dream like that often reveals that the track of the person's life will have something to do with the said country, but this is not always so. Some people have had dreams where they see themselves healing the sick, casting out devils, and praying for mentally deranged people. What if that's the prophecy they have been looking for? What if it's the pointer to God's calling for their lives? Which most likely, is. Some people have had dreams where they see themselves speaking to an audience, but not church setting, more like a parliament meeting. What if God is showing you where he is taking you to if you will follow him? Have you been seeing yourself ministering to people in your dream? Why think too far? it will happen just as you have seen it if you keep following the Lord!

PROPHETIC UTTERANCE

“What I have shown you is my plan for you, that's exactly what I want to do with you. That's exactly what I ordained you for. But I need your cooperation. Follow me and I will make you! My words will not fall to the ground. My words that have come to you in dreams will not fall to the ground. Those destiny dreams are my words; they will not fall to the ground. They will accomplish all that I have sent them to do. My words that you have received will try you. That prophecy you have received through your dream will try you. Just as my words which Joseph received

through his dream tried him before its fulfilment, but stay true to me, I will do with you as I have shown you”.

THE PROPHETIC DREAM OF JOSEPH

Gen 37:5 - 11

“And Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it his brethren: and they hated him yet the more. And he said unto them, Hear, I pray you, this dream which I have dreamed: For, behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and, lo, my sheaf arose, and also stood upright; and, behold, your sheaves stood round about, and made obeisance to my sheaf. And his brethren said to him, Shalt thou indeed reign over us? or shalt thou indeed have dominion over us? And they hated him yet the more for his dreams, and for his words.

And he dreamed yet another dream, and told it his brethren, and said, Behold, I have dreamed a dream more; and, behold, the sun and the moon and the eleven stars made obeisance to me. And he told it to his father, and to his brethren: and his father rebuked him, and said unto him, what is this dream that thou hast dreamed? Shall I and thy mother and thy brethren indeed come to bow down ourselves to thee to the earth? And his brethren envied him; but his father observed the saying.”

Psalms 105:17-19

“He sent a man before them, even Joseph, who was sold for a servant: Whose feet they hurt with fetters: he was laid in iron: Until the time that his word came: the word of the LORD tried him.”

The dream of Joseph revealed a future ahead of him, it revealed greatness, leadership, and rulership as God’s plan for his life.

In fulfilment of prophecy, there's a place for growth and there's a place for a time. Joseph received his destiny dream that prophesied his future at age 17. But the dream came to pass at age 30. The thirteen years interval captured the necessary cycle of events that needed to take place before the prophecy came to pass.

Genesis 41:46

“And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.”

Through those thirteen years, the words of prophecy were trying him. The trials were stages to the fulfilment of prophecy. From the pit of betrayal by his brothers to being sold to slavery in Egypt, to Potiphar’s wife implicating him, to imprisonment, before he got to the palace. And all along the line, prophecy was being fulfilled.

Many think the fulfilment of prophecy is an event, whereas the fulfilment of prophecy is a journey. The fulfilment of prophecy is characterized by a

cycle of events that comes to an end at the fullness of time when the foretold end happens. Joseph had a dream that prophesied his position of dominion and prominence amongst his brothers. But no one knew how it would happen. However, the divine hand of God that knows how to make all things good, be it good or bad circumstances, permitted Joseph to be sold into Egypt because that was the place of the fulfilment of prophecy. He allowed him to be thrown in jail because that was where he was to meet the man that will connect him to his long-awaited dream; the seat of dominion. And in the end, the dream came to pass. Even though, along the line, the dream had been coming to pass, but at the fullness of time, the expected end occurred.

We can liken prophecy to a seed that needs to be planted, grow, mature, and then become a fruit-bearing tree. Even Jesus likened his word to seeds in the parable of the Sower.

Prophecy manifests in phases and the phases of the manifestations are not usually as pleasant as the prophecy sounds, because prophecy usually reveals the end not the process. Just like the word of God that was given to John, he ate the scroll of the word and it was sweet in the mouth but bitter in the belly (Revelation 10:10).

Sweet in the mouth - The prophecy excites you and makes you happy.

Bitter in the belly - The word may play out through unpleasant experiences to try you and fine-tune you to make you fit for the fulfilment of prophecy.

WHAT YOU SHOULD DO WITH PROPHETIC DREAMS

Habakkuk 2:2-3

“And the LORD answered me, and said, write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it. For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.”

Remember, that at the fullness of time, the expected end will happen as foretold. This is what Habakkuk called the appointed time. Every prophecy carries an appointed time tag on it. It may look like it's taking forever, but don't ever give up on your destiny dream. It will surely come to pass. It may tarry, but wait, it will come to pass, just as you have seen it, it will happen.

But never forget, there's an appointed time. Note that, the appointed time is not first and foremost, a set date like December 2030, The appointed time is the time it takes for you to yield to the dealings of God and the training of the Spirit to the end that you mature enough for that prophecy to find expression in its fullness upon you. Your time and seasons are in God's hands. They are not measured in days and months. They are measured in heaven's dealings in your life and your yielded-ness and accurate response.

Isaiah 9:8

“The Lord sent a word into Jacob, and it hath lighted upon Israel.”

The time it took for the word (prophecy) sent to Jacob to rest (be fulfilled) upon Israel is the time it took for Jacob – ‘The deceiver’ to yield to God's dealing to become Israel – ‘The Prince of God’. The best thing you can do to

bring prophecy to fulfilment is to do all that God tells you to do. Obedience makes you align with prophecy for its fulfilment while disobedience delays prophecy.

Can you see a destiny dream and it didn't later come to pass? Scripture reveals that some prophecies are conditional, they come to pass as we align with God. If we don't, they also won't. Prophecies are predicted future events, they happen because we cooperate with God, the giver of the prophecy. God hasten to perform His words, but not without our cooperation and active partnership.

PRACTICAL WISDOM

1. Write them down

Build the culture of writing your prophetic dreams and journaling your prophecy, it reveals a heart posture of honour for God's word and it helps you to track your journey with God. It helps you to call to remembrance the things that God has shown you, the remembrance keeps faith in the vision alive in your heart.

Habakkuk 2:2

“And the LORD answered me, and said, write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.

2. Read to run

Train yourself to read the words and prophecies God has given about your life. When the enemy succeeds in taking away the memory of a prophetic dream, then he has stolen the seed of faith from your heart. Faith in the word God gave you through the dream is a major requirement for the fulfilment of the prophecy.

2 Peter 1:12

“Wherefore I will not be negligent to put you always in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and be established in the present truth.”

Reading helps you call to remembrance; retaining the consciousness of what the Lord has said establishes you in prophecy. Also, reading helps you to run, in the words of God, He said, “Those who read it will run.” There is a kind of speed imparted to your journey as you consistently read the prophecy. As you read it, it helps you stay with God’s plan, establishes your feet on the preordained path and shield you from distractions of good things calling your attention. The distractions that comes from attempting to do other good things that work is a major cause of delay in prophecy fulfilment. However, reading the vision helps us remain convinced of God’s will and plan and strengthens us in the good, acceptable and perfect will of God.

3. Meditate on them

Meditation concretizes knowledge and understanding and strengthens faith. Meditation makes prophetic insight more robust and gives us further illumination in the will of God. We meditate by keeping the memory of the

dream as an object of contemplation in our minds and we think around it, in the process of thinking, we ask questions and open our hearts to receive answers from the indwelling Holy Spirit.

1 Timothy 4:14 -15

“Neglect not the gift that is in thee, which was given thee by prophecy, with the laying on of the hands of the presbytery. Meditate upon these things; give thyself wholly to them; that thy profiting may appear to all.”

Joshua 1:8

“This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.”

If we will prosper and have good success with prophecy, we will need to meditate upon the prophetic words and dreams.

4. Do not be anxious about its fulfilment

Philippians 4:6

“Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, present your requests to God”

Unbelievers are worried about the mistakes of their past and many Christians are anxious about how they will get to the revealed future. Anxiety is the restlessness that comes from one's lack of faith in God. Sometimes, we convince ourselves that we are in faith, but our words spoken from anxiety betray us. To be in faith means, even though I don't know how God is going to do this, I will rest and trust Him, as I play my part through obedience to His instructions.

Habakkuk 2:3

“For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry”

Remember, the vision is for an appointed time, so don't think you have missed it because it hasn't come to pass based on your planned time. No matter how long, wait for it, don't compromise by choosing another path different from what God revealed. Be sure that at the end, the vision shall speak. Instead of being anxious; pray, give thanks to God and keep yourself busy by obeying His instructions.

5. Wage a good warfare

How does one war with prophecy? The word of the Lord is the sword of the Spirit, prophecy is the word of the Lord and it can be weaponized. We war with prophecy through prayers and faith in the word of God. When the enemy comes to try us with offers against God's plan, discouragement and frustration, doubt and hopelessness, we can win the war by confessing and affirming the word of the Lord that we have received through the Scripture,

prophecies and prophetic dreams. When you feel confused, not knowing where to go and it is as though the pressure of life is upon you, go back to your journal, read aloud those prophecies, and blast the dark cloud with the sword of the Spirit.

1 Timothy 1:18

“This charge I commit unto thee, son Timothy, according to the prophecies which went before on thee, that thou by them mightest war a good warfare”

6. Rejoice and give thanks

Philippians 4:4

“Rejoice in the Lord always: and again, I say, Rejoice.”

Rejoice in the confidence you have in God, rejoice in the conviction that God can do what He has said concerning you, for He will watch over His word to accomplish it. Anytime you think about that dream, give thanks, because you know that just as you have been shown, it will play out, just like the dream of Joseph in the Scripture. Joy and thanksgiving are the best environmental factors for the prosperity of faith, hence, over that prophecy, stay joyful and rejoice.

CHAPTER 6

RECEIVING BLESSINGS IN DREAMS

Psalm 127:2 Amp

“It is vain for you to rise early, to retire late, to eat the bread of anxious labours— For He gives [blessings] to His beloved even in his sleep.”

Spiritual blessings can be received through dream as earlier stated. True blessings are spiritual and tangible, which then manifest in the physical and material realm. Through dreams, the impartation of virtues and transference of spiritual heritage is possible.

Certain things that happen to men in dream realm are real-time events, they are not figments of the imagination. They happened; they are real. Dream realm is not just a place where we are shown things, but also a place where we are given things, and things are imparted to us. Some of the blessings that people receive through dreams are;

1. Spiritual Impartation

When you have a dream where you were imparted by a servant of God or your parent or someone you honour, the impartation you received is real, something tangible has entered your life. Whatever they gave you is real, it's a living treasure that entered into your spirit. Soon enough it will begin to manifest on the earth as you acknowledge and exercise yourself in that impartation.

Case study of Solomon

1 Kings 3:5-15

“In Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, ask what I shall give thee. And Solomon said, Thou hast shewed unto thy servant David my father great mercy, according to as he walked before thee in truth, and in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart with thee; and thou hast kept for him this great kindness, that thou hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day. And now, O LORD my God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David my father: and I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in. And thy servant is in the midst of thy people which thou hast chosen, a great people, that cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude. Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people? And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.

And God said unto him, because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life; neither hast asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies; but hast asked for thyself understanding to discern judgment; Behold, I have done according to thy words: lo, I have given thee a

wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee. And I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the kings like unto thee all thy days. And if thou wilt walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as thy father David did walk, then I will lengthen thy days. And Solomon awoke; and, behold, it was a dream. And he came to Jerusalem, and stood before the ark of the covenant of the LORD, and offered up burnt offerings, and offered peace offerings, and made a feast to all his servants.”

Solomon had a dream where the Lord appeared to him at night and blessed him with wisdom. God gave him a wise and understanding heart in his dream. He slept as an ordinary man, a king just as any other. But he had a dream where he met with God, and he woke up a different man. He woke up wise, wealthy, and more honourable than any man alive in his time. This wasn't just a dream, it was an encounter, it was a life-transforming experience, it was all that was needed to align young Solomon with his destiny. This tells us that God can come to us in our dreams to interact with us, impart us, bless us and release spiritually tangible materials into our spirit. Whatever happened to our human spirit in our dreams happened to the whole man: the spirit, soul, body, and life circumstances will align with it with time.

The sort of impartation that Solomon received is such that affected his whole being; his spirit, soul, and body were immersed into the reality of that impartation. The word of blessing from the Lord came into his spirit as light to brighten it up, entered into his mind to upgrade it with a program of divine understanding into things, and awakened portions of his brain cells for the activation of a thinking capacity that's not common to men. All these happened to Solomon through a dream.

The impartation on Solomon was so real that when a case was brought to him immediately after the encounter, he manifested the unbeatable wisdom of God. This made the whole nation of Israel feared the king and honoured God's wisdom in Him. Below is the account of the matter brought to him.

1 Kings 3:16-28

“Then came there two women, that were harlots, unto the king, and stood before him. And the one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house; and I was delivered of a child with her in the house. And it came to pass the third day after that I was delivered, that this woman was delivered also: and we were together; there was no stranger with us in the house, save we two in the house. And this woman's child died in the night; because she overlaid it. And she arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me, while thine handmaid slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom. And when I rose in the morning to give my child suck, behold, it was dead: but when I had considered it in

the morning, behold, it was not my son, which I did bear. And the other woman said, Nay; but the living is my son, and the dead is thy son. And this said, no; but the dead is thy son, and the living is my son. Thus they spake before the king. Then said the king, the one saith, this is my son that liveth, and thy son is the dead: and the other saith, Nay; but thy son is the dead, and my son is the living.

And the king said, Bring me a sword. And they brought a sword before the king. And the king said, Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other. Then spake the woman whose the living child was unto the king, for her bowels yearned upon her son, and she said, O my lord, give her the living child, and in no wise slay it. But the other said, let it be neither mine nor thine, but divide it. Then the king answered and said, give her the living child, and in no wise slay it: she is the mother thereof. And all Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to do judgment.”

2. Transference of Spiritual Heritage

Spiritual inheritance can be transferred through dreams. Through a dream, God can connect you to His covenant in a spiritual lineage, and He can release upon you the grace and mantle carried by men who are fathers.

You may see a person, or angel or the signification of Lord stirring up this inheritance in a dream, praying, imparting, or prophesying upon you for the transference of virtue. Dreams like that don't come to just reveal, but to also impart.

Remember the Bible says, your inheritance is in and amongst the saints – men in Christ (Ephesians 1:18). Callings and ministries have their strength in tribes and covenants are transferred in lineages. Therefore, God can connect men to saints in their spiritual tribe and lineages through dreams. Some of them, you may never meet physically, but it doesn't change the fact that what they transferred to you in a dream is real.

Mantles for ministry are transgenerational, and it does have multiplier effect across generations. If a man wears a mantle and stir its power for supernatural result and heavenly harvest, when that mantle is coming upon another generation it will rest in a stronger way on several people for greater harvest, that's the multiplier effect. Also, different people within a generation can carry a shared mantle. My father does not have to die for me to carry what's on him, I don't have to die for my seeds in the faith to carry what's on me. Once and again, in your dream, God can use the image of certain men of God whom you revere to release a blessing upon your life, an impartation of grace for assignment or a mantle for your ministry which they will release in the measure of what they steward in Christ. Either this people are still alive on earth or have transited to heaven, it doesn't make a difference.

Case study of Jacob

Genesis 28:12-16

“And he dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven: and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it. And, behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, I am the LORD God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: the land whereon thou liest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed. And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth, and thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and in thee and in thy seed shall all the families of the earth be blessed.

And, behold, I am with thee, and will keep thee in all places whither thou goest, and will bring thee again into this land; for I will not leave thee, until I have done that which I have spoken to thee of. And Jacob awaked out of his sleep, and he said, Surely the LORD is in this place; and I knew it not.”

Here is the testimony of Jacob the son of Isaac and grandson of Abraham. God had made a covenant with his grandfather and the same covenant was upon his father, then God came to him in a dream to align him with the generational covenant. The preordination of God over Jacob was to give him honour above his brother that he may inherit the heritage of the firstborn even though he wasn't the firstborn of Isaac. The prophecy has been foretold that Jacob will lead his brother, even before he was born. While he was still in the womb, God spoke to his mother.

Genesis 25:23

“And the LORD said unto her, two nations are in thy womb, and two manner of people shall be separated from thy bowels; and the one people shall be stronger than the other people; and the elder shall serve the younger.”

Jacob perhaps was aware of this prophecy and his mother also attempted to help him fulfil it through carnal means. Through deception, he received the transference of blessings from Isaac his father (Genesis 25). This couldn't have been God's way, because God is just and His ways are pure, with Him there is no deception. Jacob had to flee from his brother because he was afraid that his brother could harm him. The ungodly flee when no one pursues him but the righteous is as bold as lion.

Jacob ran from home to the house of Laban, his uncle who was a master deceiver, who deceived him in no small way. It became a case of the deceiver being the victim of deception. Jacob in his journey testified of Laban's deception.

Genesis 31:7

“And your father hath deceived me, and changed my wages ten times; but God suffered him not to hurt me.”

God needed to align Jacob to the true blessings of Abraham, he couldn't get it by playing smart and being unjust. For this reason, the dream came. The dream came to connect him to the generational covenant that began with his grandfather. God introduced Himself to him as the God of Abraham and Isaac; his grandfather and father; with this, God was calling his

attention to what began before he was born which he needed to connect with for his destiny.

Spiritual heritage can be of two origins, one that will advance life and the one that will hinder a life. The spiritual heritage of blessings, covenant of good things, and virtues has its origin in God, but the heritage of curses, the covenants of evil things and vices has its origin in the devil. Many people have been connected to spiritual heritages in their lineage and family ancestry through dreams. The dreams come to bring them into awareness of what's available and activates them into functionality. The response of people to these dreams matters a lot, they can choose either to agree or disagree with what any dream says or seeks to impose upon their lives as realities. If the dream comes to align you with blessings in your family lineage, agree by giving thanks, acknowledging, and affirming the blessings in and over you. If it seeks to align you to an evil ancestry, disconnect from it by standing on the truth of the finished works of Christ that has redeemed you from vain things you have inherited from your forefathers.

1 Peter 1:18-19 AMP

“For you know that you were not redeemed from your useless [spiritually unproductive] way of life inherited [by tradition] from your forefathers with perishable things like silver and gold, but [you were actually purchased] with precious blood, like that of a [sacrificial] lamb unblemished and spotless, the priceless blood of Christ.”

3. Instructions

God can use dreams to bring instructions and reveal the direction we ought to take as we journey through life. When we need God's direction, we can pray and expect Him to send us help, one of the channels it can come through is dreams. After God instructs us through dreams and we are convinced of His voice, it will be disobedience if we do otherwise.

Case study of Joseph

Matthew 1:20-21, 24

“But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost. And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for he shall save his people from their sins.

Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto him his wife.”

Here, there was a situation and Joseph didn't know what to do. He was a man who feared the Lord, but what was before him seemed greater him, he needed to be sure what he was to do. While he was thinking about it, he slept. In his dream, the angel of the Lord came to him to tell him what to do. The angel of the Lord brought clarity to his confusion and light upon the darkness of his ignorance.

There was a dire need for divine intervention because there was no explanation that Mary could give that would be good enough to convince Joseph that she was a pregnant virgin. There was also no frame for Joseph to assimilate such information, it has never been heard of before. He couldn't simply handle it, and he thought of putting her away secretly, so she doesn't become an object of public shame. Taking her to be his wife with a pregnancy will put Joseph at risk of being falsely accused of impregnating the lady he was espoused to, whom he had not yet married. He needed some courage to do that.

God was aware of his weakness and dilemma and He sent help to him through a dream. The dream brought clarity to the confusion, faith to his heart, courage to please God, and instructions on what to do.

We cannot underestimate the power of God-inspired dreams; they do more than what words can capture. They can impart a conviction in one's heart that dissolves doubt and enhances faith. They come with a pictorial and graphical message that sticks to the mind and is difficult to forget. They can carry you for a lifetime. An example of this in scripture is how Joseph the son of Jacob, when he saw his brothers in Egypt, remembered the dream he had about them 13 years ago. This is to say; some dreams never die and they can stick to the heart as long as a person is alive.

Genesis 42:8-9

“And Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him. And Joseph remembered the dreams which he dreamed of them, and said unto them, Ye are spies; to see the nakedness of the land ye are come.”

4. Warnings

We will escape many troubles if we will pay attention to the things God communicates to us through dreams. Oftentimes, God warns us ahead, that we may escape coming danger. He sends warning signals through dreams to call our attention to the evil along our way or the door of sin opened before us; warning us not to become victims and cheap preys. Warning dreams calls our attention to our tendency to fall into certain temptation, to the end that we can pray and adjust in obedience to righteousness. If we are attentive enough, we'll always have a way of escape. Warning dreams can come as you seeing yourself doing a wrong thing in the dream and the consequence was grave. Upon your waking moment, your response should be to pray that God will keep you from falling in that area as you consciously watch to ensure that you are standing. Let him that thinks he stands take heed lest he falls. (1 Cor. 10:12).

Job wrote about this:

Job 33:14-18

“For God speaketh once, yea twice, yet man perceiveth it not. In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falleth upon men, in slumberings upon the bed; Then he openeth the ears of men, and sealeth their instruction, that he may withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man. He keepeth back his soul from the pit, and his life from perishing by the sword.”

CASE STUDY OF ABIMELECH

The Lord gave a dream to one Abimelech to warn him from an impending danger that would have befallen him if he touched the wife of Abraham, the prophet.

Genesis 20:3-8

“But God came to Abimelech in a dream by night, and said to him, Behold, thou art but a dead man, for the woman which thou hast taken; for she is a man's wife. But Abimelech had not come near her: and he said, Lord, wilt thou slay also a righteous nation? Said he not unto me, she is my sister? and she, even she herself said, He is my brother: in the integrity of my heart and innocency of my hands have I done this. And God said unto him in a dream, Yea, I know that thou didst this in the integrity of thy heart; for I also withheld thee from sinning against me: therefore, suffered I thee not to touch her. Now therefore restore the man his wife; for he is a prophet, and he shall pray for thee, and thou shalt live: and if thou restore her not, know thou that thou shalt surely die, thou, and all that are thine. Therefore, Abimelech rose early in the morning, and called all his servants, and told all these things in their ears: and the men were sore afraid.”

People fall into untold troubles because they wouldn't pay attention to the written word, inward witness, or the dreams God sent to them as a witness to warn them from impending danger. For those who have a true

heart before God, God helps them to please him. The Lord said to Abimelech in the dream, because of the integrity of his heart He withheld him from touching Sarah.

This also brings me to say that, dreams are common to humans. It's human to have dreams, because it's one of the ways God leads and speaks to men, either saved or unsaved. The ability to dream is a blessing God endowed humanity. The advantage the believer has is the potential to hear God through other means; the Scriptures, inward witness, and voice of the Lord in his heart and all these helps him judge and receive the best of his dreams and discard what needs to be discarded.

Sometimes, people have dreams where they see themselves having sexual affairs with close colleagues or the opposite sex that they are not married to. This kind of dream comes to warn the people to take necessary steps or make adjustments or else they will fall prey to sexual impurities. We may feel like such can't happen until the devil begins to cause circumstances to help ungodliness. Dreams where we see ourselves doing things outside the will of God are usually warning signals that come to draw our attention to make adjustments in those areas. It's one of God's ways of helping us to please him.

God warns us from taking steps that can lead to sin (the actions of sin gives place to the devil) and to keep our soul from destruction. God had to warn the wise men from returning to Herod after they found the child Jesus, through a dream (Matthew 2:12). That intended action could complicate things for the parents of Jesus, even though Herod was too small to kill the King of kings. Through a dream, God changed their direction.

5. Directions

God can tell us where to go or what direction to take through a dream. God desires to guide us as we journey through life. He wants to show us what step to take per time that will lead us into what He has ordained for us. The wise man said, “Acknowledge God in all your ways and He will direct your path” – Prov. 3:4-5. The answers to the questions of where to be based, who to marry, which job to take, what church to join; can come through dreams, hence the need to pay attention to our dreams.

Case study of Joseph

Matthew 2:13-14

“And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him. When he arose, he took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt.”

Joseph received direction from God's angel in the dream, he told him where to go for safety. The instruction of direction was so strong that he arose and that same night and fled to Egypt. To disobey such divine directive can endanger his family. When God gives us directives through dreams and we confirm that the directive is from God, we ought to obey promptly. The most important response to God's instructions and directives is not writing it in our journals, but prompt and absolute obedience.

Every dream must be judged, tested, and proven to be of God before we respond to instructions from them. Any dream that instructs us against the testimony of the Scripture should be discarded. The word of God is more valid and the voice of the Lord in our conscience surer than any dream or vision.

6. Creative Ideas

God can give us creative ideas through dreams. God is a creator full of creative light and wisdom, and He has called us to partner with Him that His kingdom may come upon the earth. We partner with Him by yielding to Him and manifesting His nature, even His creative nature. God wants to give us creative wisdom and idea for inventions and innovations to the end that men will see our good works and glorify His name. We can pray over a matter before sleeping and expect to have creative dreams where ideas and divine inspirations are gotten. The expectation of the righteous will not be cut short.

Meditate around the problem you are trying to solve, with a strong desire to break forth into light and find answers. Pray about it and expect God to show you what you don't know. Be open and highly expectant in your sleeping moment knowing that the solution can come through dreams.

Case study of Jacob

God delivered Jacob from the deception of Laban and hugely compensated him. God sent His angel to give him a creative idea on genetic engineering, this idea led to his invention of the mechanism that can alter the skin colour and patterns of animals.

Genesis 31:6 -12

“And ye know that with all my power I have served your father. And your father hath deceived me, and changed my wages ten times; but God suffered him not to hurt me. If he said thus, the speckled shall be thy wages; then all the cattle bare speckled: and if he said thus, the ringstraked shall be thy hire; then bare all the cattle ringstraked.

Thus, God hath taken away the cattle of your father, and given them to me. And it came to pass at the time that the cattle conceived, that I lifted up mine eyes, and saw in a dream, and, behold, the rams which leaped upon the cattle were ringstraked, speckled, and grisled. And the angel of God spake unto me in a dream, saying, Jacob: And I said, here am I. And he said, Lift up now thine eyes, and see, all the rams which leap upon the cattle are ringstraked, speckled, and grisled: for I have seen all that Laban doeth unto thee.”

Below is the account of the technology revealed by the angel in a dream. Just as Jacob, you too can receive a creative and innovative idea, a detailed and graphic picture of global solutions through dreams.

Genesis 30:37- 43

“And Jacob took him rods of green poplar, and of the hazel and chesnut tree; and piled white strakes in

them, and made the white appear which was in the rods. And he set the rods which he had pilled before the flocks in the gutters in the watering troughs when the flocks came to drink, that they should conceive when they came to drink. And the flocks conceived before the rods, and brought forth cattle ringstraked, speckled, and spotted. And Jacob did separate the lambs, and set the faces of the flocks toward the ringstraked, and all the brown in the flock of Laban; and he put his own flocks by themselves, and put them not unto Laban's cattle.

And it came to pass, whenever the stronger cattle did conceive, that Jacob laid the rods before the eyes of the cattle in the gutters, that they might conceive among the rods. But when the cattle were feeble, he put them not in: so the feebler were Laban's, and the stronger Jacob's. And the man increased exceedingly, and had much cattle, and maidservants, and menservants, and camels, and asses.”

Other examples of men who had creative dreams that helped them made such an impact in the society are;

- Elias Howe the inventor of sowing machine, had a dream where he was chased by cannibals who wanted to cook him. They all had holes in their spears. When he woke up, he got the perfect idea that he needed for the needle-hole he was working on, to finish up the sowing machine he was inventing.

- August Kekule, after working on the structure of benzene for long without success, had a dream. He saw snakes biting their own tails and that became the inspiration of the idea he needed for the structure of benzene.
- James Cameron of the block buster movie titled Terminator, fell very sick. He had a dream, there was an explosion and a robot came out with kitchen knives pursuing a girl. He woke up and quickly wrote it down as story line that became the Terminator movie.

CHAPTER 7

INTERACTING WITH SAINTS IN DREAM

ONE SPIRIT AND ONE BODY

The church of Christ is eternal, it is the family of God in heaven and on earth. Everyone who is born again is a member of the same body, a part of the same loaf of bread, we are members of one another, inseparably united as one.

The church of Christ is not just the family of God on earth, it's far bigger than a global or universal entity. It's an eternal entity whose life is the very Spirit of the eternal God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Ephesians 3:14-15

“For this cause, I bow my knees unto the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, of whom the whole family in heaven and earth is named.”

The beauty of the Body of Christ is such that, a member cannot claim to be united with Christ – The Head, and not be united with the Church – His body. If by the Spirit of the Son in your heart you are united to Him, then also, if the same Spirit dwells in your brother, you are also one with him.

Ephesians 4:3-6

“Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace. There is one body, and one Spirit, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling; One

Lord, one faith, one baptism, One God and Father of all, who is above all, and through all, and in you all.”

Whether you are aware or not, every member of the body of Christ carries something that is in you and you carry something that is in each one too. It is the same “*life, spirit or blood*” that flows through us all. For it is through His Spirit that we are baptized into the same body.

1 Corinthians 12:13

“For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit.”

THE MYSTICAL UNION

It is worthy of note that the body of Christ is not localized nor is it geographically limited. The body of Christ is a spiritual and eternal entity through which Jesus fills up all things, both in heaven and on earth through the immortal and eternal Spirit of God our Father.

Ephesians 1:22-23

“And hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church, which is his body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all.”

Due to this mystical union that we share in Christ, it makes it inevitable for members of the body to fellowship with one another in the Spirit. The connection we share by the Spirit will bring about the physical connection

and the spiritual connection (through dreams and visions) of the saints. By the operation of our Father through his Spirit, His children will be made to see eye to eye. He makes the saint on one end of the globe to meet his brother at the other end of the globe. He makes His sons in heaven to meet their brothers on earth for fellowship in light, for sharing of spiritual virtues, activation of inheritance, and the compacting of the body through that which every joint supply.

Ephesians 4:16 KJV

“From whom the whole body fitly joined together and compacted by that which every joint supplieth, according to the effectual working in the measure of every part, maketh increase of the body unto the edifying of itself in love.”

Ephesians 4:16 TPT

“For his body has been formed in his image and is closely joined together and constantly connected as one. And every member has been given divine gifts to contribute to the growth of all; and as these gifts operate effectively throughout the whole body, we are built up and made perfect in love.”

The body of Christ is made up of recreated human spirits. Everyone who gets born again is baptized into this body by the same Spirit, and he immediately becomes an integral part of the body. Everyone who is born of God is made to drink into the same Spirit, to partake of the life that we draw from the Holy Ghost who is the life source of the body.

The same way that the human body prospers through the circulation of blood and water through the many membered human body, the body of Christ also prospers as we experientially share the spiritual essence that we all are designed to carry as we assemble and fit into Christ our head. The gathering of the saints is crucial for the compacting of the body. The gathering of the saints across places and time zones and in heaven and earth is the system God designed for the health of the Church.

VISITATIONS IN VISIONS AND DREAMS

The church of Christ has its origin and primary habitation in the heavenly kingdom with its address being mount Zion. We all have come to Mount Zion, the city of the living God.

Hebrews 12:22-23 AMP

“But you have come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to myriads of angels [in festive gathering], and to the general assembly and assembly of the firstborn who are registered [as citizens] in heaven, and to God, who is Judge of all, and to the spirits of the righteous (the redeemed in heaven) who have been made perfect [bringing them to their final glory].”

This scripture tells us our primary habitation is mount Zion, the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem. This is where everyone who is born again is primarily domiciled. This then tells us that we are in the same spiritual geography with everyone who is born again, both those who are

awake in the flesh all over the world and those who are asleep in the flesh having their bodily habitation in heaven. We all are at Zion; Sharon from Chicago, Ernest from Dublin, Amaka from Nigeria, Amanda from France, Abraham from Haran (the father of Isaac), Paul from Tarsus (The apostle who wrote 13 epistles) are my neighbours in heaven.

The consciousness of heaven is a primary requirement for heavenly experiences. Paul instructs that we set our affection on things above, visitations from heaven are part of these things above.

Colossians 3:1-2

“If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God. Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth.”

When we desire and earnestly seek the things of the Kingdom, the Kingdom overwhelmingly comes for us. We usually get in return, more than what we bargained for. Visitations in dreams and visions capture the graphical revelation of what's happening with us in the heavenly Kingdom realm. It's a way heaven brings us into an awareness of what is happening with our reality above. The place of interactions with the saints captured in dreams and vision is primarily the Kingdom realm of heaven. However, there must be a way that the saints on earth are brought into an awareness of the things their spirit is engaging within the heavenly realm. Hence, the gateway of dreams and visions are employed to help us.

Probably, as you are reading this, some of your experiences are coming alive and making more sense to you. Before now, you have had dreams

where you see your pastor, a servant of God you honour, or a saint you read about whether alive or has exited to heaven, teaching or speaking to you of the Kingdom of God. These sorts of dreams are usually not parabolic, rather they are what took place or is taking place in the heavenly kingdom realm.

Our response to these dreams should be an open heart, with the knowledge that God has sent his children to us to release the supplies they carry for our growth, advancement, and fulfilment of destiny. Sometimes, you wake up from a dream with a knowing that you just had an experience of a lifetime that comes with an overwhelming presence of the glory of God. Most times, the impartation from such dreams is so tangible that you wake up slain under the power of the Holy Ghost.

I had sometimes in 2016. In this dream, I saw Kobus Van Rensburg of South Africa, the founder of Spirit Word ministries who went to be with the Lord in December 2013. We were in a meeting and he was teaching, and he came to where I was and tapped me by the back and said to me “In him we live, we move and have our being, our movement in him is upwards not sideways”. Then I woke up. I believe God used his servant to show me light into the scripture by a visitation. From the visitation, I came into a deeper understanding that our movement in God is ascension.

Acts 17:28

“For in him we live, and move, and have our being....”

Psalms 24:3

“Who shall ascend into the hill of the LORD? or who shall stand in his holy place?”

When you see the people you honour in your dream or visions, whether they are still alive or not; teaching, prophesying, instructing or praying for you, did you really made a contact with them, or it is just their image you saw? Oh, you most definitely saw them, you just had an engagement with their spirits. When Jesus was on the mountain, Moses and Elijah appeared to him in a vision, was it their images he saw or he saw them? He definitely saw them and engaged them in discussion.

Sometimes in dreams, images from our mind and memory are used to paint pictures to help us understand something. Some other times, it is not just revelation you are having but a visitation, an encounter in the Spirit realm.

Certain inheritances will not be stirred unto functionality in a saint's life unless he meets certain sons of God. Paul, the mighty man of God, at his new birth experience had to be visited by Ananias, a disciple of Jesus to open his eyes and impart him with the Holy Ghost (Acts 22). He needed the supply of another saint for his advancement. God has structured the members of the body to be interdependent. We need one another across time and space and the divide of heaven and the earth. Since the veil of separation has been torn through the crucifixion of Jesus, we have free access to our father and our siblings by the same spirit of adoption. God orchestrates such divine experiences, ours is to discern, know and receive them in faith and joy as they are an essential part of our building unto perfection.

TALKING TO THE DEAD?

When we see people who are asleep (dead) in our dreams or vision, is it not necromancy? Necromancers are those who practice the arts of speaking to the dead through occultic means.

Who is the dead? In the New Testament scriptures, we will see that many redefinitions happened. The dead are those who do not share in the life of the Son of God, those who believe not in Jesus and have no eternal life. The wages of sin is death and the gift of God is life eternal. To die is to be estranged from eternal life.

Those who come to God through Christ before they give up their earthly tent (body) are said to have “slept”. It is called “sleeping” because they will rise again. (Romans 6:23, John 3:18, 1 Corinthians 15:51-52). Here is what Jesus said;

John 11:25-26

“Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live: And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this?”

Matthew 22:32-33

“I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob? God is not the God of the dead, but of the living. And when the multitude heard this, they were astonished at his doctrine.”

Those who have faith in Christ never die. They have risen from death to life through faith in the son of God. Hence, to see Reinhard Bonnke in your dream is not necromancy, it is your brother visiting you.

Jesus, on the mount of transfiguration, was visited by Moses and Elijah, and they discussed the destiny of Jesus. These are not dead men, because God is the God of the living and not of the dead. Jesus wasn't practicing necromancy here. He was simply talking to His relatives on the other side of the divide.

Luke 9:28-32

“And it came to pass about eight days after these sayings, he took Peter and John and James, and went up into a mountain to pray. And as he prayed, the fashion of his countenance was altered, and his raiment was white and glistering. And, behold, there talked with him two men, which were Moses and Elias: Who appeared in glory, and spake of his decease which he should accomplish at Jerusalem. But Peter and they that were with him were heavy with sleep: and when they were awake, they saw his glory, and the two men that stood with him.”

The safe place is in knowing that saints appear in our dreams at God's discretion. It wasn't written that Jesus summon Moses and Elijah. Simply be open to receive God's blessings through saints in your dreams, but don't attempt to initiate it, for to do so is to be walking on slippery ground, and the manifestations of false spirit may be the result. If Benson Idahosa, Billy Graham, John the beloved or your grandmother who loved Jesus, appears

in your dream to discuss the kingdom with you, don't be afraid that you are practicing necromancy, you are not, it is simply a visitation from your family members above, initiated by God.

CHAPTER 8

DREAM INTERPRETATION; THE GIFT AND THE SKILL

Here is a short story about myself. In May 2020, I hosted a course on demystifying dreams. But the word of the Lord already came to me in May 2019 that, He will have me host a dream interpretation class. I wanted to host the course in 2019, but the Lord told me, “You haven't proved the grace you have to interpret dreams yet”. I knew the Lord was saying I don't have enough experience in dream interpretation to host a school on dream interpretation.

So, I let things be while I focused on fine-tuning my dream interpretation skill by exercising the grace I had received. I then became a dream seeker. I went around seeking for dreams to interpret. And any time I have an opportunity to exercise myself in dream interpretation, I gave it my very best shot as I relied on the Holy Spirit for revelation. I noticed that when I began, it usually takes days to be able to crack the code of some dreams. But one thing I hardly did was give up on a dream because I didn't understand it. I rather ask the dreamer for more time for me to seek God for understanding.

I quite understand that this is the work of the Lord and I must relate with it with all sense of fear of God and sobriety. I mean, I am representing God to His people and prophesying to them by interpreting their dreams, visions, and experiences. I don't do it shabbily, because I know that destinies are involved here. When someone comes to me seeking help on dream interpretation, I love to push the limit of my faith by picking the challenge to interpret the dream. I believe God led him to me, and He wants to use me to give him an answer of peace. So, I find it hard to say, “Go away, your

dream is too hard to understand”. And the fear of God won't make me just say anything, hence the need for waiting on the Lord for precision, accuracy, and a conviction in my heart that I am speaking from God's heart.

When the burden of the Lord begins to prosper in our hearts, we are signing up for supernatural dimensions and grace. It is also good to bear men's burden. I learned how to prophesy by bearing men's burden, I go to God in prayer to receive a word for them that will comfort them. The grace of God doesn't answer to a heart posture of selfishness and self-centeredness. I sought God's face, asking Him to use me to answer the questions of men and to put smiles on people's faces. Many people have found direction in life as I engaged myself in dream interpretation. That alone gives me joy and makes me seek God more, asking that He will do more through me and not allow me to be stuck in yesterday's testimony.

I won't particularly say I have a special gift of dream interpretation, but I can say I know when it began. I can trace it to when I was in a believers' gathering in Ogbomosho, Oyo state in May 2019. During one of the sessions, an impartation of the spirit rested on me and I just knew that I have received an impartation of the Spirit for dream interpretation.

The new creation is designed to come into functionality by divine encounters. His destiny is designed to get unlocked by encounters, spiritual experiences, the revelation of the word and prophecy among others.

Many folks have received impartations and prophetic words like I did that day, and they go to sit down and do nothing about it. They expect that one day it will start to manifest, whereas, it is them that need to exercise it. Every impartation you receive is a spiritual weapon for kingdom advancement that you must learn to skilfully wield, to bring profit to the

Kingdom. It is the responsibility of everyone to exercise themselves in the impartations they have received and the dimension unlocked to them by the words of Jesus through prophecy and the revelation of the written word.

1 Timothy 4:14

“Neglect not the gift that is in thee, which was given thee by prophecy, with the laying on of the hands of the presbytery.”

It is you that will stir up the gift which is in you, no one will do that for you, not even the Holy Ghost. It's your job to stir up the gift you have received. Many have concluded that the way to stir up the gift is by praying in tongues, this is accurate. Praying stirs the gift in you, exercising it stirs the gift to flow out of you to bless the people for whom you were given the gift. The gifts and grace of God upon our lives will continue to lie dormant if we don't exercise them, through usage. Praying about a dimension of the spirit to flow through us is not enough, we must also step out in faith to practice that dimension knowing that God will back us up.

The grace and gift you have received of God is your cutting edge, you sharpen it by training, getting knowledge, and using it. The grace of God in your life is serviced by usage.

Now, do not say, “What if God has not asked me to interpret people's dreams?” Instead, the question should be, “Is God happy that people are confused because they couldn't get the interpretation of their dreams? The answer is, no! He desires that people hear His voice plainly so they can take the right actions. Understand that dream interpretation skill is a tool for harvest. Every believer is supposed to be able to interpret their dreams.

How? Through intimacy with the Holy Spirit and understanding of the Scriptures. Jesus said, the Holy Spirit will guide you into all truth. John also told us that we have the anointing of the Holy one and we know all things. (John 16:13, 1 John 1:20).

The reason for a discourse on dreams like this is to the end that we become skilful enough to interpret the dreams of unbelievers and kings, to help men hear what God is saying, as the Holy Ghost leads their hearts to God. I believe that God wants to raise Josephs and Daniels who have proven skills of dream interpretation and can boldly stand before kings and say, “Our God is with us and He will give us the answers to your questions and the interpretation to your dreams”.

WHAT IF I HAVE NO GRACE FOR DREAM INTERPRETATION?

1 Corinthians 15:10

“But by the grace of God I am what I am: and his grace which was bestowed upon me was not in vain; but I laboured more abundantly than they all: yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me.”

Grace is lavishly poured out on the man who is willing to labour. Have you heard people talk about others saying, “That brother has special grace for prayers or that sister has special grace for prophecy, or that pastor has special grace for healing”? Those whom we say have special grace for certain things; when asked their side of the story, we may discover the place of diligent labour and continuous exercise and stretch they had to go through before they saw any supernatural result in their lives.

The man that consistently prays for hours today, could not pray for one hour at a time. However, he kept on praying, until he can pray for an hour, then two, then three, then four. The man who has great results in healing today, at a time was having no results. The hands we call specially anointed today was once ordinary, but he kept laying it anyways. There was no result, yet he continued until he began to get results. The person we call a great prophet today, at a time prophesied amiss, but he didn't allow that to hinder him. Rather he continued, trusting the Lord to do it better next time. The man we call the great dream interpreter today, at a time he didn't even know that farmlands in dreams could mean harvest field or the Lord's vineyard. Yet, he kept on making attempts. This is a major secret; practice is the key to proficiency in supernatural manifestations.

As a new creation, there's nothing impossible to you if you believe. Faith is your access to grace. You exercise your faith in the area of grace you trust God to use you in. This tells us that grace answers to consistency in exercising faith to express God's power or wisdom. Hence, let no one say, I don't have the grace! Jesus, the embodiment of grace lives in you. What you don't have is the courage to pick up the challenge in faith to bring solutions.

DESIRE AND EXERCISE

1 Corinthians 12:31

***“But covet (OR DESIRE) earnestly the best gifts:
and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way”
(Emphasis is mine).***

There's no spiritual gift or grace that you cannot operate in, at least to a measure. There are those whose ordination is to steward certain dimensions of grace; they find it easy to do certain things supernaturally by the anointing of the Spirit. For instance, Prophets and prophecy, Evangelists and healing and miracles. Yet, we must never forget the transacting principle for all; by faith we have access to grace. Supernatural manifestations don't just happen, our part is to earnestly seek them by desire expressed in prayers. We receive the grace or gift by faith and stir the grace or gift by usage.

Proverbs 18:1

“Through desire a man, having separated himself, seeketh and intermeddleth with all wisdom.”

This man wants wisdom, but the desire is the first thing he expressed, then he separated himself to wait upon the Lord (Prayers), then he sought for wisdom, and the fountains of wisdom opened to him.

Daniel, from the Scriptures, had a grace released upon him to understand all dreams and visions.

Daniel 1:17

“As for these four children, God gave them knowledge and skill in all learning and wisdom: and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.”

God gave Daniel the supernatural ability that he had. He understood all visions and dreams. The scripture above makes it appear as though, as you say your dream, Daniel had the answer. But then, one day King Nebuchadnezzar had a dream which he forgot and he needed not just an

Interpreter but a spiritual man that could tell him his dream by word of knowledge and then interpret it. Here is what Daniel did.

Daniel 2:16

“Then Daniel went in, and desired of the king that he would give him time, and that he would shew the king the interpretation.”

He requested time. Everyone who is growing in the grace of dream interpretation should know that you don't hastily jump into interpretation. It's okay to ask for time. What did he do with the time?

Daniel 2:17 - 18

“Then Daniel went to his house, and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions, that they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret; that Daniel and his fellows should not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.”

He gathered his companions to pray because dream interpretation does not answer to the intellect, books, and works of literature; rather it answers to the revelation that comes from the Holy Spirit and we access these spiritual revelations through prayers.

When this truth is established in your heart, it will shift the focus from you to God. If the focus is on you, you will feel pressurized, learn to shift your focus and men's focus to God. The Bible says *“The secret things belong to God but the things revealed belongs to us and to our children's children.”* (Duet 29:29).

Daniel 2:26-28

“The king answered and said to Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, art thou able to make known unto me the dream which I have seen, and the interpretation thereof? Daniel answered in the presence of the king, and said, the secret which the king hath demanded cannot the wise men, the astrologers, the magicians, the soothsayers, shew unto the king; BUT THERE IS A GOD IN HEAVEN THAT REVEALETH SECRETS, and maketh known to the king Nebuchadnezzar what shall be in the latter days. Thy dream, and the visions of thy head upon thy bed, are these...”

Daniel knew this secret; he knew how to turn men’s attention to his God. Joseph knew this secret as well, and it was the major strength of his manifestations in Egypt.

Genesis 40:8

“And they said unto him, we have dreamed a dream, and there is no interpreter of it. AND JOSEPH SAID UNTO THEM, DO NOT INTERPRETATIONS BELONG TO GOD? TELL ME THEM, I PRAY YOU.”

THE SKILLSET OF DREAM INTERPRETERS

- 1. Accurate knowledge of the Scripture:**

The Scripture sets the boundary and scope of our interpretations. We must not go outside of what is written when interpreting dreams. God-given dreams are His words revealed in sound and images and they won't contradict the written word. Therefore, we must be students of the Word, who knows what the Bible says about everything. Some dreams that are in form of parables come to us in the language of scriptures; hence, the more knowledge of scripture we have, the better interpreters of dreams we become.

1 Corinthians 4:6

“And these things, brethren, I have in a figure transferred to myself and to Apollos for your sakes; that ye might learn in us not to think of men above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another.”

Colossians 3:16

“Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.”

2. Prayer:

Accurate dream interpretation can only happen because God reveals His secrets. As children of God, we have access to God by His Spirit, who is the wellspring of wisdom and revelation. Through prayers, we engage Him and fellowship with His thoughts and secret things. God told us in His word, that

we should call unto Him and He will answer us by opening our eyes to reveal to us, things we do not know.

Jeremiah 33:3

“Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not.”

Ephesians 1:16 - 17

“Cease not to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers; that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him”

3. Inquisitiveness:

We must have the desire to search out the deep things of God. God takes pleasure in hiding His hallowed things, so that only the diligent seeker can find them. Diligent seekers of God will receive the reward of the revelations of God.

Proverbs 25:2

“It is the glory of God to conceal a thing: but the honour of kings is to search out a matter.”

Hebrews 11:6

***“But without faith, it is impossible to please him:
for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and
that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.”***

We must be hungry for accurate spiritual revelations of the things of God. Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after righteousness, for they shall be filled. Many folks don't like to be challenged, they don't like to be stretched, they like to remain in their comfort zone of ignorance and zero spiritual relevance. We must be willing to go the extra mile in prayers, fasting, and meditation for spiritual revelation. God is a rewarder of diligent seekers; not shabby seekers, who only want to do what is convenient. As prophetic people, if we want to grow, we must have a heart that yearns for the revelation of the things in God's heart, that posture of inquisitiveness positions us for light and understanding.

4. Total dependence on God:

For every dream you want to interpret, depend on God afresh. Don't depend on your intellect, books you have read and your past dream interpretation experience.

Proverbs 3:5

***“Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean
not unto thine own understanding.”***

Lastly, God gives us gifts and grace, but skills are acquired. The skill of spiritual know-how comes as we consistently put the gift or grace to work. You become skilful at a thing by constant practice. You can know what works

and what doesn't work through experience, even as you obey the word of God to the best of your knowledge.

As said by a sage by the name Dr Val, “Persistence wears our resistance.” The resistance to your accurate interpretation of dream will wear out as you persist in exercising yourself in dream interpretation, do this with uttermost dependence on the Holy Spirit; our guide into all truth.

N.B – I employed the use of the word “Skill” in this chapter to imply maturity in administering a spiritual gift for the profiting of the Kingdom.

CHAPTER 9

PROPHETIC SYMBOLISM AND TERMINOLOGIES

Daniel 1:17

“To these four young men, God gave knowledge and understanding of all kinds of literature and learning. And Daniel could understand visions and dreams of all kinds.”

If Daniel could understand all dreams, then could there be a mechanism to it? was there a particular way he used to interpret dreams? Is there technical know-how to dream interpretation?

The revelations of the Spirit can be caught by a ready and hungry heart. By careful meditation on these revelations, they become understanding. The things of the Spirit can then be taught through knowledge because the teacher has an understanding of the subject matter.

Are there traceable patterns in the ways of God? A man that understands the patterns of God can predict God, and the reason is this, the consistency of God is based on his unchanging nature. His operations stem from the reality of his nature that is consistent, hence the possibility for patterns. If God gives dreams and has been giving dreams since the beginning, then could there be a pattern in the way God reveals His mind to people through the medium of dreams?

The reason a man can consistently interpret dreams accurately is because of these three major factors:

1. His dependence on God.

2. His understanding of dream language and symbols.
3. His ability to translate the symbols and then interpret the dream in a way that is peculiar to the dreamer, with the help of the Spirit.

If Moses understood the ways of God, so can we, who are in Christ.

Psalm 103:7

“He made known his ways unto Moses, his acts unto the children of Israel.”

We can understand God's ways concerning dreams. We can learn how to hear God's voice for ourselves and others through dreams. But then, it's not a thing we learn in a day, it's a journey. Daniel had a supernatural impartation for understanding all dreams, but he had to exercise himself in dream interpretation to activate that impartation. You get better in whatever you do consistently.

I have studied broadly on dream interpretation, but I wouldn't be able to build trust in God to use me in that area if I didn't attempt to interpret dreams; there is no growing in faith without actions of faith. The consistent attempt in faith later gave me a measure of spiritual know-how on the subject.

KINDS OF DREAMS

There are basically two kinds of dreams, they are;

1. Plain or Literal dream

These are dreams that need no interpretation, however they need to be understood in order for them to be rightly applied. This kind of dream is not coded in symbols, they are literal. What you see and heard is what it is, no

underlying meaning that need to be discovered. God gives literal dreams, like the dreams of Joseph who was espoused to Mary.

2. Complex or parabolic dream

These are dreams that are coded and needs to be decoded. Just like the parables on Jesus in the Bible, where He says things in order to convey a deeper message and meaning, this dream comes with deeper meaning that what is seen and heard in the dream. The pictures, symbols, words, sounds, voices, moods etc, used in the dreams are intended to lead the dreamer to a place of light where the message is, if He will trust God for interpretation. Complex dreams need translation and interpretation for them to be understood, like an English who received a letter in French and needed someone who understands French to help him read and understand the message. Dream translation is the reading of the French, dream interpretation is explaining the meaning of the letter so that the English can understand.

God gives parabolic dreams to His people, Daniel had parabolic dreams in the Bible, he had to seek God to understand and he understood them through accurate interpretations.

SPHERES OF DREAMS

The sphere of dreams represents the coverage of the message of a dream, the who, what, why and where of the message is captured in the sphere of the dream. There are two spheres of dreams:

1. Intrinsic dreams:

These are dreams that border around the issues of your hearts and your relationship with God. These dreams are personal to you, you are the main focus of the message of this kind of dream. There may be other elements in the dream, but your life is the focus. It amplifies the thoughts of your heart. It also reveals God's plan for your life. Examples of intrinsic dreams:

- The prophetic dreams Joseph had about his future in Gen 37.
- The prophetic dream Jacob had where God connected him to the covenant that He made with his father and grandfather in Genesis 28.

2. Extrinsic dreams

The extrinsic dream focuses on something or someone other than you. This dream brings a message about people, churches, cities, or nations. Usually, people dream intrinsically, only a few people have extrinsic dreams. The closer our relationship is with God, the more extrinsic dreams we will have.

Generally, prophets, watchmen, intercessors and leaders over spheres tend to have more extrinsic dreams. God acknowledges thrones and seats of power, because men sit there on the account of His appointments and permissions. He reveals to kings and leaders a measure of His plan for the sphere over which they have been appointed; it doesn't matter if the leaders are born again or not. Examples of extrinsic dreams; the dream Pharaoh had about the coming famine to Egypt and the nations in Genesis 41 and the dream of Nebuchadnezzar in Dan 2. These two leaders are core idolaters, yet God spoke to them by a dream. This is to also establish that God can and does speak to every single man on earth in any way he chooses to. However, the sons of God through faith in Christ have access to talk to him and

understand what Him better. These two kings didn't understand what they saw because understanding God's message is connected to knowing God's ways by fellowshiping with Him.

Extrinsic dream can be a call to intercession or a call to declare the word of the Lord to those involved, or the revelation of God's counsel and plan for the sphere over which He has appointed you as leader.

DREAM INTERPRETATION PROCESS

In dream interpretation, two processes are involved:

- Dream translation
- Dream interpretation

Dream translation is converting the dream from a symbolic language to a plain language. Dream interpretation is revealing God's mind to the dreamer in a personal way; it is helping the dreamer to hear what God is saying through the translated symbols. Note that you can interpret a dream without first translating it by the Spirit. Translation is one of the ways we arrive at interpretation but not the only way. In translation, you look to the decoding of the dream to hear God, but when you want to interpret without first translating, you look to God the giver of the dream and He will simply tell you the same thing He is saying through the encoded dream. Both ways work just fine.

One can be knowledgeable in dream translation and not be a dream interpreter. You can read books on dream symbolism and language and know about translating the symbols of people's dreams, but translation is

different from interpretation. Although you know that “gate” means “access” or “blue” means “heavenly”, it doesn't mean you know exactly what God is saying to the dreamer. Even new agers can translate dreams, but they can't interpret dreams for anyone to hear God's voice.

Dream translation can be learned, but dream interpretation is strictly based on dependence on the Holy Spirit. That's why for every dream you are interpreting you must have a heart posture that says, “Help me Lord, what exactly are you saying to him/her?” You can depend on your experience to translate dreams, but you can't depend on your experience to correctly interpret dreams.

Deuteronomy 29:29,

“The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children forever, that we may do all the words of this law.”

Prophetic dreams are God's secrets; their interpretations have to be revealed. The confidence of an interpreter should not be his last successfully interpreted dream. His confidence should be in his ability to turn to the Spirit within. The greatest skill of the interpreter is in his ability to listen to the Lord's voice and yield his heart to the Lord and not trust his experience but God. When a man assumes the position of a dream interpreter, he is standing as God's prophet, God's spokesman, and Oracle. Hence, the need to build a culture of dependence on the Holy Ghost.

The Bible says “None of Samuel's word fell to the ground”. You can always have 100% success in your dream interpretation. 100% success is not first about getting it perfectly correct, it is perfectly representing God!

When I began to exercise myself in the gift of prophecy, one thing I learned from prophet Kirby De Lanrolle was this, ‘When you are prophesying, don't set your focus on ‘I just have to be correct’; rather, set your focus on, ‘I desire this person to be edified by God’. When you are too focused on correctness, you will be afraid to yield to God in a bid to not be wrong.

Every time I am interpreting dreams, I stand at that same spot that I usually do when I prophesy by God's spirit. Dream interpretation, just as the interpretation of tongues is tantamount to prophesying. Know that when you are interpreting a dream, you are prophesying, so do it with honour and reverence for God.

DREAM LANGUAGE

From the study of the Scripture and the revelation of the Spirit, I found that there are four dream languages. They are:

- The language of God.
- The language of the current civilization.
- The language of the dreamer.
- The language of nature.

Let's briefly look into each of these dream languages.

1. THE LANGUAGE OF GOD

(Unchanging: as revealed in scripture)

God has a way He speaks. Jesus many times spoke in parables and interpreted the symbols used in His parables. I tell people, to understand dream language, first of all, understand Bible language, because the language of God is written in the Bible.

Jesus said in the Scripture, “I am the bread of life, he that feeds on me will never die” - John 6:51. Is Jesus “Captain cook bread” or “Shoprite bread”? Of course, not. For we know that the bread is the word, and Jesus is the word. To eat the bread of life is to receive the revelation of the Kingdom into our hearts.

If you want to grow in understanding dream language. Read the parables of Jesus and see how Jesus used symbols, also check out the interpretation of those symbols. Jesus spoke in parables a lot, and till now He still speaks parables. Parables are not meant to remain as parables to us who are in Christ Jesus, because we have what it takes to understand the symbols. “*To you, it has been given to know the mysteries of the Kingdom*” (Matthew 13:11)

Another example, Jesus talking about the harvest of souls, said,

John 4:35-38

“Say not ye, there are yet four months, and then cometh harvest? behold, I say unto you, lift up your eyes, and look on the fields; for they are white already to harvest. And he that reapeth receiveth wages, and gathereth fruit unto life eternal: that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together. And

herein is that saying true, One soweth, and another reapeth. I sent you to reap that whereon ye bestowed no labour: other men laboured, and ye are entered into their labours.”

Here is Jesus using the language of agriculture to explain eternal things. He wasn't talking about the harvest of corn, wheat, or barley, He was talking about the harvest of souls. At another place, Jesus was talking about doing the Father's will and He said...

John 4:34,

“Jesus saith unto them, my meat is to do the will of him that sent me, and to finish his work.”

Can you ever imagine that the symbol of meat in a dream could be talking about something that has to do with the Father's will? Let's look at John 15.

John 15:1-2, 4

“I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman. Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abides in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me.”

Jesus used a tree to represent a family relationship, between the Father, Himself and the saints. This means, trees in a dream could be referring to a family lineage.

Also, Psalm 1 tells us that the righteous is as a tree planted by the rivers of water, and whatever he does he shall prosper. So, a tree by the riverside in a dream can be calling your attention to Psalm 1.

Psalm 1:3

“And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.”

From Scripture, the Colour red could symbolize sin, meanwhile, it could also symbolize the blood which is somewhat reddish in colour.

Isaiah 1:18

“Come now, and let us reason together, saith the LORD: though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they be red like crimson, they shall be as wool.”

The colour white symbolizes purity and righteousness.

Revelation 19:8

“And to her was granted that she should be arrayed in fine linen, clean and white: for the fine linen is the righteousness of saints.”

The more you get familiar with the Bible, the better you understand God's language, and in extension dream language.

2. THE LANGUAGE OF THE CURRENT CIVILIZATION

(Subject to change as civilization advances)

God will not likely show Aaron a dream to talk about communication using the symbol of a telephone or handset. He simply won't know what that is, it will be strange to him because during his days, civilization wasn't that advanced. Rather, God may use a trumpet, because it's easier for him to understand. It's a symbol that the people were familiar with in his days.

Let's briefly analyse the dream of Pharaoh and the interpretation of Joseph.

Genesis 41:2-7

“And, behold, there came up out of the river seven well favoured kine and fat fleshed; and they fed in a meadow/pasture. And, behold, seven other kine came up after them out of the river, ill-favoured and lean fleshed; and stood by the other kine upon the brink of the river. And the ill-favoured and lean fleshed kine did eat up the seven well favoured and fat kine. So, Pharaoh awoke.

And he slept and dreamed the second time: and, behold, seven ears of corn came up upon one stalk, rank and good. And, behold, seven thin ears and blasted with the east wind sprung up after them. And the seven thin ears devoured the seven rank and full ears. And Pharaoh awoke, and, behold, it was a dream.”

Read this carefully, noting that God spoke to Pharaoh in the language of his days. Let's see the interpretation of Joseph.

Genesis 41:25-32

“And Joseph said unto Pharaoh, the dream of Pharaoh is one: God hath shewed Pharaoh what he is about to do. The seven good kine are seven years; and the seven good ears are seven years: the dream is one. And the seven thin and ill-favoured kine that came up after them are seven years; and the seven empty ears blasted with the east wind shall be seven years of famine.

This is the thing which I have spoken unto Pharaoh: What God is about to do he sheweth unto Pharaoh. Behold, there come seven years of great plenty throughout all the land of Egypt: and there shall arise after them seven years of famine; and all the plenty shall be forgotten in the land of Egypt; and the famine shall consume the land. And the plenty shall not be known in the land by reason of that famine following; for it shall be very grievous. And for that the dream was doubled unto Pharaoh twice; it is because the thing is established by God, and God will shortly bring it to pass.”

Note that, Joseph interpreted this dream by dependence on God and by the understanding of the language of the civilization of his days. Joseph fully

depended on the Holy Spirit, recall that he didn't have the Bible to consult. Dream interpretation is easier for us now because we have the Bible.

He saw seven fat cows come out of the river. In the civilization that Pharaoh had this dream, wealth was measured in livestock and farmlands amongst other things. This civilization didn't start in Egypt, as the wealth of Abraham was also measured in cattle.

Genesis 13:2

“And Abram was very rich in cattle, in silver, and in gold.”

And river or waters represents nations, which Joseph knew by the Spirit.

Revelation 17:15

“And he saith unto me, the waters which thou sawest, where the whore sitteth, are peoples, and multitudes, and nations, and tongues.”

Joseph could connect that the fat cows that came from the river represent the booming economy of a nation, and in this case, the nation of Egypt. He knew it was the nation of Egypt because it was the king of Egypt who had the dream. Your dreams usually cover your sphere of influence.

An average Christian may interpret seven to mean perfection, but Joseph yielded to the spirit and knew that in this dream, the number seven (7) was talking about time. Most times, when numbers are striking in dreams, they are usually symbolic of time. Remember, in the dream of the baker and the cupbearer in Genesis 40, three baskets symbolized three days and three branches also symbolized three days.

He knew the seven fat and flourishing cows represents season of economic boom in a seven-year period, and the other seven ugly and lean cows represents a seven-year period of recession. *The ugly cows will swallow the fat fine cows.* This means the season of the economic boom will be swallowed by the season of economic recession. And it will be as though there were never years of plenty in the land.

Then pharaoh had the second dream.

“And he slept and dreamed the second time: and, behold, seven ears of corn came up upon one stalk, rank and good. And, behold, seven thin ears and blasted with the east wind sprung up after them. And the seven thin ears devoured the seven rank and full ears”.

Remember, wealth is measured in livestock and harvest field or farm produce in those days. So, this dream also talked about the season of economic boom and recession.

God showed him the same thing twice, to say that the matter is true and it is established. Joseph spoke by the Spirit that Pharaoh had the dream twice because the matter is established, which was later written in the law of Moses and the New Testament.

Deuteronomy 17:6

“At the mouth of two witnesses, or three witnesses, shall he that is worthy of death be put to death; but at the mouth of one witness he shall not be put to death.”

2 Corinthians 13:1

“This is the third time I am coming to you. In the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word be established.”

The Lord said to Moses, “Anyone termed worthy of death shouldn’t face the punishment of death except at the mouth of two or three witnesses”, because, at the mouth of two or three witnesses the truth is established.

This is how Joseph interpreted the dream of Pharaoh, it wasn’t magical and mysterious; he simply depended on God's Spirit and he used the understanding of dream language.

3. THE LANGUAGE OF THE DREAMER

The language of the dreamer is used when God employs the usage of images of things that are peculiar to the dreamer, in sending a message to him via dream. If you have a dream where you see yourself at your place of work, your secondary school, your room, putting on your best shoes, eating your best meal, playing your favourite game; all these are personal to you. These images and elements are familiar to you, they are of the language you regularly speak. They are not general for everyone.

This is one of the reasons why dialoguing is important in dream interpretation. The interpreter might need to ask the dreamer some personal questions to decipher what the Lord is saying since the Lord is speaking in a language personal to the dreamer.

The language of the dreamer spoken through dreams usually comes with a plain message to the dreamer. Like the dreams of Joseph in Matthew 1 and

2 where angels showed up and told him to take Mary his wife because the child in her womb is the seed of the Holy Ghost. He had another dream where an angel manifested and instructed him to flee to Egypt with the Mary and child lest the child gets killed by Herod. He didn't wake up to think the dream is about someone else, because the elements and images used in the dreams are personal to him.

4. THE LANGUAGE OF NATURE

Romans 1:20 NLT

“For ever since the world was created, people have seen the earth and sky. Through everything God made, they can clearly see his invisible qualities—his eternal power and divine nature. So, they have no excuse for not knowing God.”

The things God created reveal to us His ways, nature, and Word. Nature is constantly speaking and God does use the language of nature to speak to us. Natural elements usually carry specific relatable meaning in dream, like sun and moon signifying time and season, mountain – height, rain – refreshing, lion – strong leader, sheep – meek, eagle – flight and speed etc.

Psalms 19:1-2

“The heavens declare the glory of God; and the firmament sheweth his handy work. Day unto day uttereth speech, and night unto night sheweth knowledge.”

When you see natural elements in your dream, sometimes, what those elements naturally signify is a part of the interpretation.

NO DREAM IS TOO HARD

When faced with a dream of any kind, we must always acknowledge that we can interpret it with God's help. We can do all things through Christ who strengthens us - Phil 4:13.

Philemon 1:6

“That the communication of thy faith may become effectual by the acknowledging of every good thing which is in you in Christ Jesus.”

Acknowledge that by Christ you can interpret all dreams because the Spirit of God that knows all secret resides in you, you have the anointing of the Holy one and you know all things (1 John 2:20). Reckon that God is with you and you can do all things. Let this consciousness sink in, let it be a part of you.

When I am on my own, I say to myself, "I have the anointing of the Holy One, I can interpret all dreams, I understand all visions, I dissolve doubt, I demystify mysteries, I decode hard sentences, I understand dark matters, because the Spirit of God is inside me". I am acknowledging every good thing in me and by so doing the communication of my faith becomes effectual, because a man becomes what he perpetually says. A grace you carry that you don't consciously acknowledge will not become energized, effectual and functional in and through you.

Men die with tremendous graces because they refuse to acknowledge it by their words and faith-based actions. You are God's representative on earth. If a believer comes to you with a disturbing dream, you can excuse yourself by saying, "Go and pray about it." But when an unrighteous king or an unbeliever comes to you with a disturbing dream, how will you excuse yourself? Because you can't tell him to go and pray about it. At such point, God is thinking, "I have got a man that will reveal my counsel to this unbeliever". If the dream seems to be complicated, don't tell them "Go away, I don't understand" Rather, say to them, "Give me some time".

As a believer, you have access to the secret codes of God. You have access to heaven's highly classified information; you have the access that the unbeliever who had the dream doesn't have. Unbelievers should come to us for dream interpretations because we can leverage on the name of Jesus, and we have an advantage - access to the throne where the Omniscient God is seated. Let's learn to use our leverage and advantage to be a blessing to the unreached world.

Many will turn to Christ when we interpret their dreams by the anointing of the Spirit and they are made to see how much God loves them. Just as the interpretation of Nebuchadnezzar's dream by Daniel, (The righteous man in the political sector), led to Nebuchadnezzar's 'conversion'- having reverential fear and honour for the God of heaven.

You can know what a dream is saying upon waking up when you have built fellowship with the Holy Spirit. You will supernaturally know the meaning by the knowing of revelation, it will be imprinted upon your heart. Now, either you go through the pathway of translating first before

interpreting or you want to train yourself in interpreting straight up, one thing is needful, it takes the revelation of the Holy Spirit to know the secret.

One of the places where people miss it in dream interpretation is when they are not able to tell if the dream is talking about the past, present, or future. Or which part of the dream is present or which is future. Place the dream before you and thoroughly consider the details of the dream, if it has something to do with a past situation or present circumstance. If not, then it most likely talks about the future.

Sometimes, in dreams, you can see the image of your friend doing something but then the interpretation is that that friend symbolizes you. Someone shared a dream where she saw Benson Idahosa of blessed memory, doing certain things. And I saw that the Benson Idahosa symbolized her, what the man of God was doing in the dream typifies her life.

This means that, sometimes, your image can be a symbol representing someone else's life in a dream and other times, someone else's image can be a representation of your life in a dream. How do we know which is which? Dependence on the Holy Spirit will let us in, on the secrets of God.

INTERPRETING COLOURS, NUMBERS, AND OTHER COMMON SYMBOLS IN DREAMS

Colours and their scriptural meaning

Note that these meanings may or may not apply to the way they are used in a dream. These are not absolute; they are relative to the context of the

dream. Hence, the need to be flexible. Symbols and translations are not ironclad rules for dream interpretation, they are pointers to the place of light. Colours can be the extra detail that unlocks the dream for the interpreter, hence, the need to know what the Scripture says about them.

- 1. Gold** - The glory of God (Exodus 25:18)
- 2. Amber** - The brightness of the glory of God (Ezekiel 1:4; 8:2, KJV).
- 3. Black** - Sin, death, and famine (Lam. 4:8; Rev. 6:5; Jer. 8:21).
- 4. Blue** - Heaven, Holy Spirit (Numbers 15:38).
- 5. Crimson/Scarlet** - Blood atonement, sacrifice (Isaiah. 1:18; Lev. 14:52; Joshua 2:18,21).
- 6. Purple** - Kingship, royalty (John 19:2; Judges 8:26).
- 7. Red** - Bloodshed, war (Rev. 6:4; 12:3; 2 Kings 3:22, Isaiah 1:18).
- 8. White** - Purity, light, righteousness (Rev. 6:2; 7:9).
- 9. Green** - Pasture, flourishing, fruitfulness (Psalm 23:2).
- 10. Rainbow** - Covenant (Genesis 9:12 - 13).

Numbers and scriptural meaning

Like colours, numbers are highly significant both in the Bible as well as in dreams. The dream of Pharaoh, the butler, and the cupbearer in Genesis 40 & 41 have striking numbers and these numbers were highly significant in the interpretation of their dreams.

Therefore, it is important to learn scriptural principles for interpreting numbers. If you internalize and follow the principles, they will help shield you from interpretation error or extremes.

Sometimes, multiples or reoccurring number carries the same meaning, only that they intensify the message being passed across. The spiritual significance of a number in dream is not always stated, it may be veiled, or understood by comparison with Scriptures or the witness of the Holy Spirit. However, through the Holy Spirit, we can understand how to use numbers in a dream to understand messages from heaven.

Possible symbolic meanings of numbers:

- Numbers can refer to specific time, number of days, months, years etc. This can only be known by the witness of the Holy Spirit and it is not safe to assume on this.

1. One - God, beginning, source, unity (Gen. 1:1; Eph. 4:3-4).

2. Two - Witness, testimony (John 8:17; Luke 10:1, Matt. 18:16; Deut. 17:6).

3. Three - Godhead, divine completeness, witness (Ezek. 14:14-18; Dan. 3:23-24; Mat 18:16).

4. Four - Earth, creation, winds, seasons (Gen. 2:10; 1 Cor. 15:39).

5. Five - Grace, atonement (The five books of the law of Moses, 1 Sam 17:40 - 54).

6. Six - Man, beast, Satan (Gen. 1:26-31; Rev 13:18).

7. Seven - Rest, perfection, completeness (Gen 2:2, Gen 19:30 (Seventh saying of Jesus on the cross)).

8. Eight – A new beginning (Gen. 17; 1 Pet. 3:20).

9. Nine - Finality, fullness, fruitful, gifts (Matt. 27:45; Gen. 7:1-2; Gal. 5:22-23; 1 Cor. 12:1-12).

10. Ten - Law, government (Exod. 34:28).

11. Eleven - Incompletion, lawlessness, Antichrist (Dan. 7:24; Gen. 32:22).

12. Twelve - Government, Foundation, apostolic fullness (Exod. 28:21; Matt. 10:2-5; Rev 21 :14).

13. Thirteen - Rebellion, backsliding, apostasy (Gen. 14:4).

14. Thirty - Priesthood, betrayal (Num. 4:39, Luke 3:22-23, Mat 26:15).

15. Forty - Generation (Num. 32:13, Psalm 95:10).

16: Fifty - Pentecost, outpouring of the spirit (Act 2;1 – the Holy Ghost was poured out fifty days after Passover).

17. Seventy - Appointment, commissioning nations (Num. 11:23-24; Luke 10:1, Exo. 1:5).

18. One hundred and forty-four thousand - The redeemed and the holy city (Rev 14:1-3; Rev 21:16-17).

Other symbols:

1. Gold - God's word, wisdom, judgment, purifying of one's faith, object of man's idolatry (Psalm 19:7-11, Prov. 3:13-14, Zech. 13:9, Dan 5:4).

2. Silver - Redemption (1 Pet 1: 18- 20).

3. Shoes - Journey or direction or a path to take. A new shoe can mean God is calling one to walk with him on a new path. It can also mean evangelism, (Eph. 6:16).

4. Sword - The word of God (Eph. 6:18, Heb. 4:12).

5. Belt - The truth of the word of God (Eph. 6:14).

6. Battle axe of weapons - A call to spiritual warfare (Jer. 51:20).

7. Rain - Refreshing, an outpouring of the Spirit, revival (Zech. 10:1-2, Isaiah 55:10).

8. Sun or moon - Times and seasons (Gen 1:14- 16).

9. Your House - Your house can mean represent your life. A bedroom can mean the place of intimacy, bathroom and toilet can mean the place of cleansing and purification (Mat 7:24-25).

10. Vehicle - Is it a car, bike, airplane, or canoe? Is the vehicle stagnant or moving? Who is driving it and where is it headed? Answering these questions will help to know what exactly it represents. It can talk about the course of your life, career, ministry, profession, or whatever you are engaged in that is meant to lead you to your destination as ordained by God (Luke 5:1-8).

11. School - As popularly believed, seeing yourself in your former school does not usually mean retrogression. It could mean that you should pay attention to what God has been teaching you from time past, especially if it is a recurring dream. If the Holy Spirit is our teacher as recorded in the Scripture, then it is expected that we should be a part of a school (John 14:26).

12. Exam Hall - In every school, tests and exams are part of the curriculum. Dreams where you see yourself in an exam hall, are to bring you into an awareness of a season of trial and test that's before you. Trials of faith are prerequisites for increase and promotions in the things of God. (1 Peter 1:7).

13. Watch or Clock - This element comes to reveal the understanding of time and season either about your life or the church or territories (1 Chron 12:32).

14. Pregnancy - Sometimes, dreams of pregnancy reveal that there is something that God wants a person to birth; a vision, call, ministry, assignment, or seed of destiny. For some, it may mean actual children depending on the context. (Isaiah 66:7-9).

15. Snakes - Snakes have contrasting meanings in the Scripture. It can mean deception and demonic assault that brings fear. The devil appeared to Eve as a serpent in the garden of Eden. (Genesis 3:1, Luke 10:19). It also represents the wisdom and stealth that God expects the righteous to manifest. Jesus said to His disciples to be as wise as serpents (Mat 10:16).

16. Flying or Soaring - Many see themselves flying in the dream, many see that they are being attacked and all of a sudden, they begin to fly above the assault. It usually shows that God is lifting you above limitations and hindrances. This element of dream also shows that God is calling us to soar with him in the spirit through waiting in prayers. Generally, flying in the dream is positive (Isaiah 40:31).

17. Past relationship(s) - Dreams, where you see yourself with your former partner consistently, may mean that you need to prayerfully break

soul ties. It may also mean that there are grey area of offence and hurt that needs to be cleared out. This once happened to me, before I got married. I was once engaged to a lady I thought I was going to end up with, but along the line, things didn't work and we parted ways. After a while, I got engaged to my wife. Then I began having dreams where I see this former lady as though we were still in a relationship. I asked the Lord and he asked me to prayerfully break soul ties. I did, and the dreams stopped. Sometimes this element also represents habits that you need to let go of. (Isaiah 43:18).

19. Being chased - Dreams where you see yourself being chased usually talk about fear. It sometimes reveals the hidden fear you have in your heart. The Scripture says the righteous are as bold as lions. For God has not given us the Spirit of fear, but of love, power, and sound mind. (2 Timothy 1:7).

20. A honoured minister of the gospel - Servants of God usually symbolize God, as his messengers in dreams. They usually come to do that which God wants to do. If they give you a prophecy or prayed for you, it is God giving you a blessing through your dream (Hebrews 7:7). Sometimes, they represent dimensions in God that they operate in, depending on the context of the dream, God can use their image to call you into a particular type, order or style of ministry.

21. Presidents or leaders - Usually when God gives you dreams about presidents or other leaders, it's a call to intercede for them. (1 Timothy 2:1-2).

22. Dead or alive relatives - Dreams about relatives that are alive can be a call to intercede for them or prophesy God's will to them. Or it can be that their image is used to symbolize us, where whatever played out around them in the dream is talking about us. If they are dead, it may mean that we are

to check our emotional connection to them and prayerfully ask God to heal our hearts of the pain of their loss. If they are our grandparents or parents, it may be talking about generational heritage in the bloodline either good or evil, that God wants to call our attention to, so that we can either receive the blessings or reject the evil. We will need discernment and dependence on the Holy Ghost to know how to perfectly decipher these sorts of dreams and how to respond also.

Mood

The mood of a dream also has a part to play in interpreting the dream. Does the dream come with a sense of fear, worry, doubt, anxiety, pressure or joy, peace, calmness, comfort, edification, consolation, purity, etc.

The kingdom of God is righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost (Romans 14:17). In the presence of God there is fullness of Joy and He will keep in perfect peace those whose hearts are stayed on Him. Dreams from God will bear the nature of His Kingdom, imparting your emotions with moods that are natural to the Kingdom. If the dream does not reveal the nature of God's kingdom, then it should not be embraced as a something that God wants to establish in your life.

CHAPTER 10

DEALING WITH SEXUAL RELATED DREAMS

Are sexual related dreams good or evil? Can they bring a message for you?

Many have sexual dreams and almost every adult has had sexual-related dreams at a point in their lives. It's a cause of torment for many, it makes some feel like they have sinned or they are unfaithful to their spouse, it can also make some feel defiled, while some does not feel there is any big deal about it.

JUDGING SEXUAL DREAMS

We cannot successfully judge any dream until we can tell its source, this same principle applies to sexual dreams. Here are the sources of sexual related dreams:

1. Natural body chemistry

Our body by design is biological and our body and soul are highly connected. Hence, the sexual desires of our bodies can be projected to us as sexual dreams. These dreams are caused by chemical reaction (hormonal activities) and sometimes the impact of the weather or even the movement of your cloth on your genitals. This sort of dream has no spiritual implication. Some people wake up to find out that they are wet around their genitals even without a dream they could lay hold on, this is usually caused by body chemistry and biological process. Wet dreams are common with teenagers who are growing into puberty as a result of hormonal activities,

and it is purely biological. However, when someone has consistent sexual dreams, then it's mostly likely not natural.

2. Unrenewed mind

Overflow of thoughts from your conscious mind to your unconscious mind happens when you sleep. Your subconscious mind receives those thoughts and projects them to you in images. Let us consider the following;

A. If a man opens the gateways of his mind to sexual things like sexual movies, conversations, magazines, pornography and engages sexual thoughts in his mind, they will stir sexual desires (lust) and these desires can birth dreams of manifestations. Just as Isaiah recorded that an hungry man who desires food can sleep and have a dream where he sees himself eating.

Isaiah 29:8

“It shall even be as when an hungry man dreameth, and, behold, he eateth; but he awaketh, and his soul is empty: or as when a thirsty man dreameth, and, behold, he drinketh; but he awaketh, and, behold, he is faint, and his soul hath appetite.....”

B. The unhealed memory of past ungodly sexual activities can cause sexual related dream. Especially if there is a soul tie (strong emotional connection) involved.

C. Unhealed past sexual abuse i.e., rape, can cause consistent violating/tormenting sexual dreams.

D. When a person yields his body to sexual perversion like masturbation, homosexuality, pornography etc. they will have sexual dreams. Defiled thoughts and lifestyle will birth defiled dreams.

3. Demonic Realm

Dreams from demonic realm happens when the devil manipulates one's dream. The devil oppresses and subjects one to bondage through dreams. How does this happen?

A. Demonic activity perpetrated through witchcraft, sorcery, spells to subject men to spiritual and physical bondage. People can have consistent sexual dreams caused by demonic powers stirred by the actions of wicked men.

B. Covenant or truce with the Devil. Sometimes, sexual dream is caused by covenants our parents entered on our behalf, with demons through idolatry, either before we were born or when we were young. This is also caused by covenants we unknowingly or knowingly entered by having sexual intercourse with someone possessed by an unclean spirit. Demonic afflictions of unclean spirit can be imparted to people through the gateway of sex.

1 Corinthians 6:16 MSG

“There is more to sex than skin to skin. Sex is as much a spiritual mystery as physical fact. As written in scripture “The two become one.”

This sexual dream source is the reason for the coinage “Spirit spouse (husband or wife)”. It usually hurts the soul and body. It can make one lose

sexual interest in one's partner, or lead to miscarriage, sickness, and insatiable desire for sex. This kind of sexual dreams feels very real, that people who have them wakes up with fatigued body and signs of orgasm as if they had real sex. People in this category are in a terrible place and they need deliverance.

4. Human Spirit

God can permit us to have sexual related dreams to warn us against sexual impurity and unfaithfulness and reveal our tendencies to us. Also, it can come to reveal points of temptation that we may need to watch out for. It doesn't come to defile you, but it gives you enough detail needed to understand the warning.

Job 33:14-18

“For God speaketh once, yea twice, yet man perceiveth it not. In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falleth upon men, in slumbering upon the bed; Then he openeth the ears of men, and sealeth their instruction, that he may withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man. He keepeth back his soul from the pit, and his life from perishing by the sword.”

What sexual dreams inspired by human spirit come to do depends on the context of the dream.

A. It can reveal strain in your relationship with your spouse so that you can adjust and make things right.

B. It can reveal ungodly sexual desires that you have or a tendency for sexual impurity, this too is so that you repent and turn from evil.

C. It can also reveal the devil's plan to bring sexual temptation, which you need to watch out for.

5. The Holy Spirit

Many do not believe that God can give them dreams with sexual inclination. Scripturally, God uses sexual immorality as an allegory for unfaithfulness towards him and deviation from the truth. Sometimes the image of sexual inclination can be used in a God inspired dream. This kind of dream will have zero sense of defilement attached to it. But the image will be a part of a whole picture that conveys a prophetic image.

A PERSONAL DREAM

In 2017, I had a dream. In the dream, I was a member of the force. I began to hear rumours that I have impregnated some girls. The news felt very odd to me. Then three sisters whom I recognized came to me to warn me, that they do not know what I am doing but I should ensure that certain person doesn't get pregnant, they mentioned the name of the girls they were talking about, but I said I have never met them before, but they didn't believe me. Just when they had finished talking, a lady whose name one of the sisters mentioned earlier entered the room and I felt like, thank God. I asked her, "Please have we ever met before and do you know me?" and to my surprise, she said, "Yes, of course, I know you very well, I am not even sure if I am not pregnant for you already." I was alarmed.

Then in my confused state, I saw that I was with a lady whom I knew. She came to me to explain what was happening, she said the ladies were sent from the occult, while she was explaining, she got naked and we got sexually involved. This now really got my testimony tainted.

When I returned to the place that the three sisters were, one of them said, God placed a cup in my hand which I filled with water and later on I smashed it on the floor. Hearing that, broke me.

Then, I was in a room, and people began to gather in the compound of the house where I was, most of them had children they came with, some came with two.

Meanwhile, the story had gotten to our leader, so I was been sought for by the force. While I tried running out of the house (It's a big house), almost every room I entered, I bumped into girls who claimed to be carrying my child and they were saying to me "Pastor Shola (my native name), please come" as I ran away from them.

Finally, I got out of the building to the compound. I saw many children and their mothers, in their number. I tried to run through their midst. A woman with children called them and said "I have told you about your dad, that's him, let's go and meet him". As they approached me, I pushed the woman and ran away. It was as though all the women outside, claimed their children were mine.

When I woke up, I thought in my heart, what is this that the devil has planned to tarnish my image. But the Lord said to me "You called it tarnishing of image, but I call it 'Fathering Nations'. Those women and girls with children are human vessels carrying seeds of greatness, seeds of

ministry, seeds of divine purposes, seeds of destiny, and they will come to you to father them. Most of them will be broken and be in a mess, but you must not be ashamed to identify with them. The demand will be high but the supply of grace is abundant. To run from this will expose you to the deceit and snare of darkness. As you identify with the weak and help them become strong, you also will become stronger”.

If I wasn't sensitive to receive the divine revelation of interpretation, I would most likely have waged a war against the devil, whom I thought was trying to tarnish my image. Most of us have bound the devil for dreams that God gave us because we didn't wait on him to receive understanding. Accurate interpretation will birth an accurate response and application of spiritual revelation. Let's learn to ask God for light and understanding of our dreams.

RELATING TO SEXUAL DREAMS

Sexual dreams don't define you. They are not your conscious act. They happen to you without your intentional consent, they can reveal what you have tendencies for and they can also reveal an area of demonic affliction.

1. Should it make you feel like you are guilty or unfaithful to your spouse? No! If in your daily life, you are emotionally and sexually faithful to your spouse, you keep pure thoughts, you know Jesus as your purifier, and you hate sexual perversion.

2. Usually, the person or being involved in sexual activity with the dreamer is a pointer to the source of the dream. The other pointer is the emotion involved in the dream; pain, oppression, excitement, etc.

3. Should you treat the dreams as insignificant and be comfortable with them? No!
4. Judge the source of the dream and address it from the correct discernment of the source.
5. Does every sexually inclined dream have spiritual significance? No!
6. Should you seek help if the dreams are reoccurring and you seem not to be able to do anything about it? Yes!
7. If a sexual dream makes the dreamer have an orgasm physically, it's a bodily response to the sexual engagement of the soul in the dream realm. This is possible because of the interconnectivity between the spirit, soul, and body. But if this happens at all times, cry out for help, don't just go to a counsellor meet an anointed teacher of God's Word.

SHUTTING THE DOOR AGAINST SEXUAL DREAMS

Sex is intimacy, agreement, covenants. We deal with such dreams by breaking ties, breaking covenants, and disagreeing! Sexual dreams can leave the dreamer with negative effects in the thought realm and the body. To stop them, focus on the source and address the issue from the root. We can receive victory over anything our dream world project that's not of God by praying in the Spirit and taking our stand in the Word. Fervent prayers in alignment with Scriptures, made by righteous men, establish victory - James 5:16. Do the following;

1. If you realize it's something you caused by exposing your gateways to sexual materials or ungodly sexual relationships in the past, then repent of

them. Ask for God's mercy and purification by His blood. Ask for the purification of your conscience and your mind by His blood (Hebrews 9:14).

2. Desist from ungodly sexual conversations, scenes, pictures, pornography, masturbation, sexual imaginations, sexual actions etc. Keep your vessel pure, always. (1 Thess. 5:22).

3. Focus on feeding your mind with holy things. Holy thoughts, desires, and imaginations. Philippians 4:8, Colossians 3:16.

4. If you have been sexually abused in the past. Ask and receive grace to forgive the person and ask the Lord to heal your heart of the hurts. You need it to advance. Meditate on God's love and receive his abundant love, for love is the balm that heals emotional and psychological pains.

5. If a sexual dream reveals your tendency for sexual impurity and unfaithfulness, repent and ask God for grace to be sexually pure. (Romans 6:14.)

6. Is the devil manipulating your dream realm? First and foremost, take time to think about how the devil gained entrance. The gateway can be the works of the flesh, sexual perversion, unholy sexual engagements, thoughts, actions and impurity. Repent of your lapses or ways you opened the doorway to demons. Ask the Lord to reveal the open door the devil is accessing to torment you. Take away the legal ground the devil has, claiming every space by the blood of redemption. By the blood of Jesus, break every covenant that gives the devil access to torment you.

SPIRIT HUSBAND OR WIFE?

That a spirit is molesting you sexually doesn't mean he or she is your spouse. On what ground are you joined? Let no one put asunder what God has joined together. If God didn't join you, then he/she isn't your spouse in truth, which means you can put double asunder! Stand on the word!

Jesus said angels are not given in marriage. It's because spirits can't get married. But then, because they are demonic spirits, they are used to perverting God's order. But you can't call a spirit your spirit husband whom you didn't agree to marry. Treat the spirit molesting you in your dream with disdain and strip him of his access to you through prayers. Jesus is your Lord; demons should keep off. This will require warfare prayers; you may ask the brethren to pray with you. Remember, you have the victory already.

If the spirit warns you of death or calamity if you attempt to talk about him to anyone, do not be afraid. Summon the courage to talk to an elder in faith, as long as you are in Christ and you believe in Him, the spirit cannot kill you. If the issue remains hidden, you will remain a slave and in bondage to the devil, but if you expose it, you will be free. God is for you, He won't allow the demon kill you or your loved ones because you did the right thing by exposing him, don't believe the devil's lies.

You can read more on how to receive freedom from such demonic bondage from my book titled "Deliverance from demonic afflictions".

CHAPTER 11

CAN DEMONIC AFFLICTION COME THROUGH DREAMS?

Matthew 13:25

***“But while men slept, his enemy came and sowed
tares among the wheat, and went his way?”***

The dream realm is a gate through which demonic affliction can enter into people's lives. The devil can latch unto people's dream realm to gain entrance into their lives. A weak spirit will be an easy passage for the devil. When a man is defeated in his dream realm, he needs to pray to lay hold on his victory through Christ Jesus, and if a man had victory in his dream realm, it happened. A testimony of defeat in a dream can be changed through faith and prayers, affirming one's victory in Christ Jesus. Never believe a dream that projects defeat, believe the word of God that assures your victory. You may be beaten up in a dream, wake up and declare, in Christ Jesus you have the victory and have won.

I had a vivid demonic dream around 2013, where a witch took my hand and bit my palm with her teeth that she had the flesh of my palm hung in her teeth, there was blood and pain on my palm. I woke up with pain at the same spot where the witch bit me. I knew it wasn't a mere dream, immediately, I laid my hands on it and check the demonic arrow out of my hand and the pain left.

Another time, I had a dream where I was anointed by a revered man of God and I received a tangible impartation of the Spirit that made my body

quaked, I woke up from that dream with the power of God all over me, I was shaking just as I did in the dream. Through the gate of dreams both evil and good virtues can gain entrance into one's life.

We need to understand spiritual things if we will advance and prosper as ordained by God. Man has a spiritual nature that is an active participant in the spirit world; where the kingdom of God and that of darkness exist. There are a lot of activities going on there in which man is playing a major part – You are playing a big role. One of the ways we are brought into the awareness of what is happening in this world is through dreams and visions.

Not every dream is revelatory, but majority of the time, they reveal your state, posture, and strength in the spirit. They also reveal what God is doing or wants to do for you and with you, and what the enemy is doing or wants to do with you and against you.

Just as one can receive God's blessings in their dreams, another can receive a demonic impartation of evil from the dream realm. And this also can be so real that it affects the whole man; spirit, soul, and body. The demonic realm knows this, reason for which they have chosen to inflict affliction and bondage upon people's life through dreams. Many people have slept and woke up sick, some have slept and woke up as invalid, many slept and woke up with fibroid, some slept, screamed from their sleep, and died. This is possible because, a man's dream realm is a gateway into his life, if he doesn't man this gate well, just anything will come in and out of his life at will.

A friend reached out to me one certain time; he had a demonically influenced dream. In the dream, he saw some people whom he doesn't know physically, they came to warn and threaten him for delivering and setting

free those they have kept in bondage. One of them went physical against him and while he struggled with her, she bit him by his head in his dream. Then he woke up, guess what? He woke up with fresh wounds of teeth bite on his head with blood flowing, it sounds unbelievable, right? He sent me a picture of it which he took with a phone camera. That's a demonic attack that came through the gate of dreams.

The Bible says *“we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities and power, rulers of the darkness of this world and the spiritual wickedness in heavenly realms”* (Ephesians 6:11-12). They are called spiritual wickedness because they exercise great wickedness from the realm of the spirit. For this reason, we are told to put on the whole armour of God by which we will be able to withstand the wiles of the evil one. Not only have we been equipped to resist the works of darkness against our lives, but we have also been equipped to deliver those who are bound by the spiritual wickedness in high places.

Isaiah 61:1

“The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me; because the LORD hath anointed me to preach good tidings unto the meek; he hath sent me to bind up the broken hearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound.”

In the case of this friend of mine, it will be unwise to say, it's just a dream because obviously, it wasn't just a dream. A dream that inflicts physical wounds or sickness on one's body is not a mere dream. It's a demonic attack and affliction. Thankfully, the Bible tells us how to handle afflictions as believers.

James 5:13

“Is any among you afflicted? let him pray. Is any merry? let him sing psalms.”

This scripture tells us that, one can be a new creation in Christ Jesus and still be afflicted. It is not automatic that a man stops suffering affliction on the account of salvation. However, the death and resurrection of Jesus have delivered the new creation once and for all from affliction. But the new creation has to lay hold on his freedom made available by Christ through the knowledge of the truth and prayers.

Now we have two action points to solve the problem before us; know the truth and pray. I called his attention to the truth of his freedom in Christ, he fasted for a few days to humble his soul before God; his help and strength, and we prayed together. God gave us victory and it ended there. People have such dreams; they wake up with fear and worry and don't know what to do. The devil capitalizes on their fear and leads them to do things that will complicate the problem.

Now, should a strong believer be attacked like that? No! My friend confessed to me that the Lord woke him up to pray but he didn't, rather he slept back and then he had that attack. Obviously, it was witchcraft attack against him, if he had just taken time to pray in the Spirit, I am certain he wouldn't have been smitten that way. Sensitivity to the Holy Spirit and obedience to His leading will always lead us out of trouble into the way of victory.

There was another case of a lady who had a dream where she saw a cat entered her leg. She woke up with leg pain, and the leg pain persisted and

hurts badly. That's a demonic affliction. Afflictions don't usually leave on their own, men must send demonic affliction packing through prayers and insistence upon the word of God. We prayed together and she was set free.

Another lady I once agreed with in prayers, had a situation where someone comes to have carnal knowledge of her in her dream. Sometimes she senses the presence of the being in her room rubbing her body sexually. As at the time we prayed together, she hasn't been able to take in (get pregnant) and she was also losing sexual pleasures in her husband. This is a demonic Affliction. God showed us the secret of this affliction, it was the house she was living in, some demonic covenants has been made over the house that puts the tenants who live there in a bondage. We prayed together to resist that devil and she changed her apartment, then she took in and gave birth to a beautiful baby.

A man whose spirit is robust through feeding on the word and much praying in the spirit is postured for consistent victory in his dream realm.

The accurate response to dreams where something evil happened to you is to wake up and pray, acknowledge the finished works of Christ by which you have been given victory, and destroy the works of darkness through your faith-filled prayer utterance (Philippians 1:6). To respond complacently is to be joking with an impending danger.

Shut the door against demons! Say this prayer with faith:

Father in the name of Jesus, I consecrate my dream realm to you as a place of divine encounters and heaven-kind visitations, a place of receiving God's blessings in Jesus' name (Psalm 127:2). I consecrate my dream

receptors (My heart and mind) by the blood of Jesus and I decree that they are sensitive to God and His kingdom (Hebrews 9:13-14). No longer will the devil manipulate my dream realm to afflict me. I decree and I declare that the doors are shut against demons and demonic visitation in my dream in Jesus. I break every tie that the enemy has with me in time past, that gave him the legal right to afflict me through my dreams, I decree no more in Jesus' name.

I repent of all that I have done, that my parents or my guardians have done before I was born or while I was young, that I am aware of or not, which opened the door for demons to afflict me in my dreams. I break every agreement, ties and covenants that I made or was made on my behalf that willed me to any demonic altar in the name of Jesus. I affirm that I am born again, I am born of God, and I belong to Jesus wholly in my spirit, soul, and body.

Therefore, I disconnect from any evil altar laying a claim over me in Jesus' name (1 Corinthians 6:19). I decree and declare, whatever give demons a legal right to defile my dream realm sexually, I redeem now by the blood of Jesus. I decree and declare; whatever man or demon defiles my body and mind through sexual dreams they are destroyed by God according to his word in Jesus' name (1 Corinthians 3:16-17). Jesus, I ask that you deliver me from every strong man that holds me captive and subjects me to torment and affliction for these past years in Jesus' name, deliver me from my oppressor (Luke 11:21-22). I shut the doorway the enemy has to afflict me through dreams in Jesus' name. Amen.

PUBLISHER'S NOTE

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Livingstone O. Oluwalola is a son of God whose quest is to know God intimately and to live for His glory. Called as a missionary prophet, he has a burden for discipleship and he stewards God's grace to disciple men through the gospel of the Kingdom. He is known for prophetic accuracy, through which many have found clarity as touching God's plan for their lives, and his teaching ministry imparts men with the burning desire to seek and know God intimately and to fulfil destiny. He believes that every believer in Christ is called to live a supernatural life, and he desires to help as many as he could to enjoy this benefit of redemption, as God grants grace.

He is the founder of The Presence Global Missions, an apostolic and prophetic mission-based ministry with different streams of expression. He is an author of several life transforming books; through his books, saints are being discipled in the knowledge of God and many are learning how to live the supernatural life in Christ.

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